MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Thursday, June 20, 2024

Date	Thursday, June 20, 2024
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	8h 0m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9glESuyYWKQ
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:02:35] And we are going to begin today with our executive session. I would just like to say that, just so everyone is aware, I have been really sick with bronchitis for the last couple of weeks.

[00:02:51] So no, I've done my antibiotic. I'm good. I just still am not exactly right with my voice. So if I go into a coughing fit, I'm tagging Bill in. So anyway, just so that you all are aware. And so with that, Mr. Hansen, will you please take us into closed session?

[00:03:08] I move that the Virginia Board of Education convene in a closed meeting for the following purposes, discussion or consideration by the Board of Education of information relating to the denial, suspension or revocation of teacher licenses subject to the exclusion in subdivision 11 of section 2.2-3705.2, pursuant to Section 2.2-3711A40 of the Code of Virginia and consultation with counsel regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice

[00:03:42] pursuant to Virginia Code Section 2.2-3711A8 of the Code of Virginia and the legal counsel to the Virginia Board of Education staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration of this matter and participate in the closed meeting.

[00:04:02] so move second all those in favor aye okay we're in closed session today in the closed

[01:32:03] meeting pursuant to a reported vote on the motion above and in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.2-3712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken place

[01:32:40] the statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes miss kilgore mr hanson dr siebert hi dr northern hi mr certifan hi miss holton i've been chair votes i okay um so now we will vote on a series of licensure matters that we have reviewed this morning uh in case number 2024 dash zero zero five the chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of michael james

[01:33:14] freeman second miss kilgore mr hanson dr siebert dr northern hi mr sturdifant miss holton and chair votes i motion carries unanimously in case number 2024-004 the chair will entertain a motion to issue a license to the applicant so miss kilgore mr hanson dr siebert

[01:33:49] dr northern hi mr sturdefin hi miss holton hi and chair votes that motion carries unanimously in the case um numbered 2024-003 the chair will entertain a motion to suspend the license of rebecca lynn yee for two years so moved second miss kilgore mr hanson no dr siebert hi dr northern

[01:34:20] hi mr sturdifant hi miss holton and chair votes i okay and that concludes our executive session materials for this morning and we will take a break for approximately 10 minutes at this point

[01:34:38] please thank you b3 of the code of virginia because her principal residence is more than 60

[01:48:45] miles from the meeting location. Dr. Coons, do you have any opening comments that you would like to make? Not today. Okay. Given that, this morning we will start off with the College Partnership Lab School Fiscal Agent and Partner Presentations and Discussion. As you all know, the board has approved a total of 14 lab schools to date, and we are very excited to see more of these schools approved and soon open. The lab school approval process was designed to ensure that only

[01:49:20] applications which were likely to result in high-quality schools, schools that would produce strong outcomes with students, and those which would be financially sustainable would be approved and ultimately funded. With the recent $25 million sweep of college partnership lab school funds and the additional financial sustainability reporting required by the General Assembly, a heightened focus of our review has been on financial viability, committed philanthropic and industry partners, and robust multi-year sustainability plans. Of these 14 board-approved

[01:49:58] lab schools, five were affected recently from the activity of the General Assembly. And as we discussed at our May 15th meeting, special called meeting, the Virginia General Assembly approved an amended 22-24 biennial budget, which was signed by the governor and became chapter one of the 2024 Acts of Assembly Special Session 1 and is in effect. Most notably, the final budget changed the eligibility definition for receiving public funds to operate a lab school from the

[01:50:31] College Partnership Lab School Fund upon enactment of the budget on May 13th and forcing a fund reduction from $100 million to $75 million. Specifically, the General Assembly modified budget language to state that notwithstanding the provisions of subsection A of section 22.1-349.1 of the Code of

Virginia for the purpose of item 137.C.4 and the College Partnership Laboratory School Fund, a quote, college partnership laboratory school means a public, non-sectarian,

[01:51:06] non-religious school in the Commonwealth established by a baccalaureate public institution of higher education, end quote. This definition now excludes five previously board-approved lab schools from eligibility to access operational per-pupil monies from the College Partnership Laboratory School Fund to operate their College Partnership Laboratory School since their lead institution of higher education was a private four-year college or two-year community college.

[01:51:38] Language in the May caboose budget further provides that subject to specified conditions, institutions that are not otherwise eligible for funding under the definition may partner with a public baccalaureate institution of higher education in Virginia to access the operational per pupil funding from the fund. Budget language requires that number one, the public baccalaureate institution must have an approved lab school application to serve as the fiscal agent and partner by June 30th, 2024. Two, proposed lab schools must resubmit contracts to the Virginia

[01:52:18] Department of Education to meet such fiscal agent and partner requirements. And three, that the lab schools must reach financial sustainability by the end of their initial approved period as defined in the code, again, 22.1-349.8. The five previously board-approved lab schools negatively affected by these new budget conditions set forth by the General Assembly include two private four-year colleges, Emory & Henry College and Roanoke College, and three community colleges, Germana Community College, Mountain Gateway Community College, and Paul DeCamp Community College.

[01:52:57] In order to access their previously approved operational per-pupil funding, each higher education institution had to partner with a public baccalaureate institution in Virginia, or their obligated monies would revert back to the College Partnership Laboratory School Fund.

[01:53:14] To achieve this, they each had to identify a public baccalaureate institution of higher education and complete and submit a fiscal agent and partnership application to the Board of Education to amend their existing lab school contracts with the board. The budget language includes no caps on baccalaureate institutions of higher education as to how many fiscal agent and partnership agreements they could enter into or lab schools they could oversee if they could appropriately handle the additional responsibilities. The board provided counsel to these previously

[01:53:51] contracted lab schools in collaboration with the Office of the Attorney General on May 22nd to provide clarity on the requirements for, quote, fiscal agent and, quote, partner. Given the lack of clear definitions available in the final budget language, these schools eager to provide access to their uniquely innovative lab schools to children across the Commonwealth promptly set out to secure a fiscal agent and partner to meet these new requirements and the deadlines. I am pleased to announced that this call was answered by Old Dominion University. The Board of Education

[01:54:26] received five fiscal agent and partnership applications to review and discuss today, all of which came from and in collaboration with ODU. This will be the space to ask questions and discuss what we learned here today. So please, let's remember that today is discussion and opportunity to collaborate and consider what's being shown and discussed here today.

[01:54:52] The board must vote Friday, June 21st, whether to approve of these fiscal agent and partnership applications in order for the institutions to amend and resubmit an amended contract by June

30th. Following the board vote, they will submit these contracts to the Department of Education and the Board of Education to continue to remain eligible for their previously approved operating fund monies.

[01:55:18] ODU, who has put forth four of their own incredibly forward thinking lab school proposals, has shown great leadership and care for our students, families, and has proven to be a leader on innovation in the Commonwealth. Not only has ODU collaborated with these additional five impacted lab schools to expand high quality educational opportunities for their students, but ODU has also brought forth an expanded definition of what it means to be a fiscal agent and partner.

[01:55:46] going above and beyond in multiple ways. ODU has a clear vision of how to exceed the partnership threshold with the launch of an entire lab school network of supports that far exceeds baseline requirements for a partner set by the Board of Education Office of the Attorney General and outlined in the May fiscal agent and partner memo that I sent out to all of the impacted institutions. That's why it's my pleasure this morning to yield the floor over to Old Dominion University's Director of the Institute for Design, Thinking, and Leadership Development

[01:56:25] and new Center for Education, Innovation, and Opportunity, Dr. Karen Sanzo, who will give an overview presentation on what the partnership means to ODU with their five proposed lab school partners who they hope to collaborate with and serve as fiscal agent and partner to. Germana Community College, Mountain Gateway Community College, Paul DeCamp Community College, Ronit College, and Emory & Henry College. Dr. Sanzo, are you ready to roll? Good, there she is. Yes,

[01:57:02] you're at the bottom of our puzzle screen of faces, so yes, please go right ahead. Yes,

[02:00:21] please hold. We're trying to get the live stream sound up for some reason. It's not working. Back? Okay. Hold on. Yes. One question is the sound, but the other is, is the public seeing the presenter and or their presentation? And I don't think they're working on that right now. Dr. Sanzo, if you could just

[02:00:46] hold for one minute. Thank you. Hey, Dr. Sanzo. Yes. Okay. Great. Yes. So good morning, President

[02:02:07] Creasy, Superintendent Kunz, the members of the board. It's a pleasure to meet with you all again and to share about the evolution of our work around lab schools our goal to provide a learning and collaboration hub for our lab school network service fiscal agent or lead partner for the lab schools in the network coordinate research to learn about and share as practices across lab schools support lab schools through providing subject matter expertise promote the robust culture of innovation we have here across virginia and identify through a network improvement community innovation and scalable educational strategies and programs. At ODU, as you heard

[02:02:44] from Dr. Payne, they believed early on in creating a network to help support teachers, administrators, students, and others as we co-designed our schools and moved to implementation as evidenced by our early development with multiple lab schools. Our ODU lab school partners have had the opportunity to engage with other lab schools through our connections with the International Association of Laboratory Schools. We've met with colleagues by phone and Zoom, attended ILS conferences in Toronto, Canada and Muncie, Indiana, and visited the UTSA lab schools in San Antonio, Texas. While we know implicitly that partnerships are important, we were struck by the power of networking and collaboration and the ways in which the lab schools can come together

[02:03:23] and amplify their efforts collectively. Seeing this in action and drawing from our own experiences and backgrounds and cultivating networks, we've moved forward to create the network and engage in a collaborative partnership not only with our own lab schools at ODU but with partners across the commonwealth as you see here represented on this map through our fiscal agent partnerships this network will enable us to work together to not only ensure the long-term sustainability of our lab school initiative in Virginia but also to help us and generate powerful research around learning innovative curriculum and teaching and educator preparation we are going to develop a

[02:04:01] networked community for lab school leaders, identify and connect subject matter experts with lab schools, provide a forum for data sharing and research support, develop professional development connected to identified lab school areas of need, and leverage our expertise and design thinking to engage with stakeholders through iterative design processes to identify and support best practices in education. Our partners will commit to sharing data and progress on goals, collaborating around joint research, sharing best practices, and participating in center events such as an annual lab school summit. ODU has a history of cultivating communities of practice and will be able to support this community. My own work around creating and

[02:04:40] cultivating networks at ODU began when I was the principal investigator for a six-year school leadership program grant in partnership with Northampton County Public Schools and this was a grant through the United States Department of Education. In my role as PI I found great benefit in speaking with colleagues and other school leadership preparation grants across the country and proposed to the U.S. Department of Education to create a communication hub to connect current and past projects. The proposal was supported by the Department of Education and I was able to create the School Leadership Preparation and Development Network. While the Department of Education provided the necessary ongoing and intensive work to support grantees

[02:05:19] around grant compliance across the lifespan of the grant, the network was able to connect K-12 and higher ed educators and their partners through conferences, webinars, joint research and collaborative work around educational best practices. We were able to generate evidence-based research and share that with stakeholders through the different communication channels both within and outside of the network. More recently, I served as the lead facilitator for the faculty PLC with the Wallace Foundation's work around principal preparation pipelines. In this role, in partnership with the University Council for Educational Administration and the Wallace Foundation,

[02:05:55] I coordinated twice a year convenings and intermediate work annually to bring together seven universities in each of their three district partnerships to learn from one another around innovative leadership preparation programs through a network community approach. I share this background with you because this previous work is similar to what we're proposing with the network.

[02:06:14] We're able to partner with our lab school colleagues to learn about and curate best practices, engage in joint research, and provide the data that we need to help others adopt innovative educational approaches from the lab schools we want to not only support support the partners within the network but also provide ongoing opportunities to engage the broader educational community me personally with my previous work with the network i found this so powerful and was able to see transformations and practice beyond the life cycle of the grant where we want to with the network disseminate our findings and scale up these innovative practices

[02:06:50] across the commonwealth and this work will also contribute to the sustainability of our lab schools as we work collectively with schools and partners our uh in terms of structure our lab school network will be overseen by an advisory council each member of the network will appoint one representative to the council as interim provost i'll select the chair uh dr sanzo will serve as an ex-officio member of the group they'll meet regularly to discuss ongoing successes challenges opportunities those that are part of the network will be expected to participate actively share

[02:07:28] data and adhere to all lab school statutes annually our center for educational innovation and opportunity will host a lab school summit with network schools participating sharing back best practices and learning from one another we are excited about this network our shared purpose can be captured in this statement, which you may know is a paraphrased quote from John Dewey.

[02:07:55] As you probably also know, Dewey created the first lab school in the United States more than a century ago. The actual quote said, "Every great advancement in science has issued from an audacity of imagination." In the context of lab schools, the word education can replace the word science.

[02:08:13] indeed the purpose of lab schools is to identify and scientifically study best practices that can be replicated in other schools in a very real sense lab schools advance the science of teaching the science of learning and the science of partnerships some might characterize our lab school network as audacious having a robust network of lab schools dramatically enhances our ability to engage in the science of education at Old Dominion University. Connecting innovative practices across the network helps to attain our vision at access to quality education for all

[02:08:53] Virginians. This vision speaks to us at Old Dominion University. Our commitment to access and opportunity drives us as an institution. It's a part of our fabric. It's what we've done in the past. It's part of what we currently do, and it will continue to be a part of our future.

[02:09:10] We thank you all for your support, and we'd be happy to elaborate further on any of what we've shared. So does any member of the board have a question for either Dr. Sanzo or Mr. Payne from this presentation? Questions? Ms. Holton? Thank you all for that terrific presentation, and thank you ODU for stepping up to the plate on fairly short notice in this new role and I can

[02:09:48] see how you were able to step up in short notice because what you're telling us is you've been heading in this direction for a long time. So you were already ready but then turned on a dime as well and so thank you for that um uh the just for my clarity's sake and transparency uh i'd like to understand what the what if anything odu is asking of the board or the department in support of this center and i assume part of that is we will be asked i think on tomorrow's agenda to approve the

[02:10:24] applications of the applicable schools with listing ODU as a fiscal agent. Is that right? And again, Dr. Coons, I don't know if this is for you or for our ODU representatives. And actually, maybe let me go ahead and list my other questions and we can get them all. So are we being asked, or is the department or the board being asked to do anything on this? And if the fiscal agent approvals is one piece. Is there anything else we're being asked to approve? And as part of the

[02:10:58] fiscal agency or otherwise, what is the funding that ODU will be receiving, either as part of those individual applications or otherwise, to support this role? Dr. Gaines, do you want to answer anything? Or do you want to pass it off to Dr. Payne and Dr. Sanzo? Dr. Payne and Dr. Sanzo, would you like to answer oh i would uh i think i it was cutting up a little bit but um uh so we are

[02:11:34] obviously receiving the the five percent of uh of overhead uh dr sanzas had to remind me as an administrator that that five percent doesn't kick in until operations begin because i i calculated a little early on my math and uh so it we will be receiving the five percent overhead and that five actually it's easier for us to administer a network like this if we have multiple institutions rather than working with with just one or two now going forward uh we will be seeking from federal

[02:12:13] sources uh from private donors from others we welcome any any suggestions about opportunities for helping to support these efforts because uh we we think there there's great opportunity here uh we think these uh uh this collaboration this network would dramatically help our our residents or help the public and uh but uh in the initial stand up we would be looking to that five percent

[02:12:46] overhead to help help get us going and so that means the only board action that is will be before us related to this agenda item is the approvals of those uh applications that are on our docket for tomorrow is that correct we do have the fiscal agent and partner uh additional the amendment pieces so that is part of what you're asking about yes as part of that

[02:13:20] okay thank you action further questions okay well thank you to dr pain and dr sanzo for your robust i'm sorry somebody else dr north it wasn't a question i was just gonna just reiterate our thanks for stepping up and taking this position at this you know it was a kind of a scramble i'm sure given the impending due dates that we're working with and just want to thank you all for not only stepping in but also agreeing to go above and beyond you know in terms of convening and that

[02:13:54] was one of the main you know visions we had for lab schools to be able to share ideas and network with one another and learn from one another so this really helps us in that facet and as a former graduate of ODU. Just super proud of the university. I feel like you guys are just knocking it out of the park in terms of just serving as a leader in the state on multiple fronts. So proud of them. Just wanted to plug you guys as well. Thank you.

[02:14:28] Okay. So thank you, Dr. Payne, Dr. Sanzo. And a special thank you to President Brian Hemphill and the Old Dominion University community as a whole for stepping up to the plate on this issue to ensure that we have this void filled and for providing these desperately needed opportunities for children in the Commonwealth. Your partnership and willingness to serve as fiscal agent and partner ensures that children across the Commonwealth will now have access to high skills and training and high demand careers post-graduation. So your collaboration

[02:15:06] and dedication to education and innovation is evident and is very, very clear to those of us on the board, the time and effort and your thoughtfulness that you've put in to scrambling on this partnership and really seeing the value and the need here is a model to the entire lab school network across the world, frankly. So I look forward to seeing your expansive lab school network flourish. I think it's going to be extremely beneficial not only to children,

[02:15:42] but to the professionals who are operating within those networks in schools. And so at this point, I'd like to introduce our first lab school fiscal agent and partner applicant, Germana Community College and Old Dominion University, to briefly speak about how their collaboration, their collaborative proposal for the board consideration tomorrow. So, I think that that means that Germana is coming first. So, if you guys would, I guess, unmute. Yes, good morning.

[02:16:16] Thank you. Good morning. Can you hear me? Yes. Okay, awesome. Good morning. My name is Dr. Keanu Hawkins. I am the Director of Equity Advancement and Early College Programs here at Germana. Good morning, President Priestley, Superintendent Coons, and esteemed members of board and the future educators academy team represent on the call today i am honored to speak on behalf of javanna our lab school was formally approved on november 15 2023 by unanimous vote the future educators academy aims to tackle the critical teachers teacher shortage by nurturing

[02:16:55] future educators in rural areas through your grow your own approach the students in the program will return to their local heists to their local counties as teachers meeting the educational needs of their local counties additionally this initiative will provide high school students with access and offer holistic comprehensive support the model is built on strong partnerships you can see this in the first year two community colleges four local school divisions and then in

[02:17:31] the second year expanding to seven local school divisions with a total of 11 we have established relationships with multiple universities to create a streamlined transfer and mentorship opportunities for our students which will eliminate barriers so having odu as a fiscal agent is the natural progression it allows us to extend our reach across the commonwealth believe it or not, ODU and Germana has been partnering since the 1990s. Being a part of this lab school network

[02:18:09] allows us to learn from our peers and become thought leaders in innovation and learning approaches. ODU, a long-standing pioneer in distance education, offers academy students with the option to access their programs without traveling far. ODU has also developed the educator preparation collaboration hub additionally this partnership would allow us to have access to research best practices and access to a network to answer common questions and concerns that may

[02:18:44] arrive by partnering with odu we are not only helping students in the future educators academy but we're also benefiting entire school divisions students and their families by 2028 these future educators will be eligible to return to their home counties and teach in the seats teaching the classrooms where they went once at i just want to give a special thank you to ovu and the board for providing opportunity and access to the students in our region and i'll answer any

[02:19:20] questions that you may have um germana thank you so much for your thorough overview and your key elements of your fiscal agent and partner application are there any board members that have questions here let's trick around look make sure okay um so before we bid you adieu for the day is there anything else you want us to know about your fiscal agent and partner application

[02:19:53] before we uh close here with with germana no to you i i'd just like to make a note that the future educators academy part of the team is lab school is complementary to the educational preparation hub are developing. And like Jomana, our goal also is to provide access and opportunity. So this provides access for undergrad, grad students, but really importantly, those high schoolers that we are focused on and just given their focus on educator preparation for us, it's a natural fit

[02:20:27] as a partnership. Dr. Tunes. I just want to thank Jomana. This is something that school divisions have been talking about in the grow your own apprenticeship model and really looking at for their leadership and opportunity to learn and grow from the opportunities that ODU and Germana are going to provide.

[02:20:46] So just wanna thank you. - Thank you, Mr. Hanson. - I would just likewise thank you for your steadfastness and working with us as a member of the Lab School Committee. I really appreciate just the diligence that has got into this from the beginning, but culminating in this partnership and really just the outcomes that we're looking achieve over the next couple of years really just appreciate the quality uh application and really where we're going to be launching with this so just thank you for your persistence and patience

[02:21:26] with this process further comments questions okay thank you so much um the board will be reviewing and deciding on your fiscal agent and partner application tomorrow during our regularly scheduled business meeting so thank you for your thoughtfulness and intentionality with this application in such a short period of time so at this point we are going to move to mountain gateway community college and their proposal for their fiscal agent and partner with

[02:21:58] old dominion university thank you my name is ben worth i'm the academic vice president for mountain gateway community college i've been a part of the team developing our laboratory school from the very beginning we're super excited about it it was approved march 28th of this past year and it's a real game changer for us we're we found a really unique way of delivering i.t information this name of our lab school is the mountain gateway information technology

[02:22:32] education center it provides training in key areas in the i.t industry cyber security cloud computing technical support one of the things that makes our lab school stand out from others are the industry recognized certifications and at the heart of it so that our students completing our laboratory experience will earn certifications that can put them right to work even while they're still in high school. We're exploring experiential learning for our seniors so they can work with local businesses in the IT industry and they can leave high school with those certifications at hand.

[02:23:06] They also have pathways into associate degrees and into baccalaureate degrees so there's opportunities for further education as well. We are a rural area. Many of our students have to travel many miles to get to our campuses and we found a delivery method that will allow students to use some of the existing transportation networks in their high school to come on our campus.

[02:23:27] For those students where coming onto campus is a challenge, we found flexible ways of delivering our instruction to allow for our students to attend our classes either through video conferencing software like we're using today or asynchronously, then that can help reduce some of the time that students need to take to get from one campus to another. So both in terms of the certifications at the heart of the program and the delivery method, we think it's going to be a real significant change for educational opportunities in our area. The opportunity for students to be able to reside locally after they complete this and go to work in high-wage, high-demand jobs is really significant.

[02:24:07] ODU is going to be a great partner for us. We have a long history of working with ODU. They've been on our campus doing online video delivery of their instruction going back into the 1990s. We recently signed an articulation agreement with them from our Information Systems Technology Applied Science. It's a two-year degree into their cybersecurity degree. This is, I think, going to be a great fit for us we're hoping that one we will be able to benefit from some of the existing relationships we have on providing quality instruction in the it industry but also

[02:24:44] their experience doing um at a distance delivery and online delivery is something we think can really help benefit our program as well because that's going to be a key component to us the conversation

side with dr santo have been very insightful and we're really looking forward to being able to take our laboratory school to the next level um would like to go on more and more about how this is going to impact the allegheny highlands and uh southern shanandoah valley but i'll stop here and ask if there are any questions from the board are there any questions from the

[02:25:20] board thank you to mountain gateway we appreciate it forward question no seeing none though would would you like to provide us anything else before we say thank you so much for your presentation?

[02:25:43] - If it's okay- - Dr. Sanzo, sure. - Yes, thank you, yes. So for us at ODU, it's also an ideal fit. As you will hear in our presentation later today, I'm quite excited about the opportunity to collaborate around digital learning and looking at how we can provide educational access and opportunities to our students are spread across regions and across divisions. We're also, as Dr. mentioned, having these conversations excited about connecting faculty experts at ODU and IT and cyber security to partner around the ways to align our work and developing workforce ready students to support

[02:26:20] the needs of Virginia. So this is an exciting partnership. Thank you all so much. And just another reminder, we will be reviewing this fiscal agent and partner application tomorrow during our business meeting and so we're going to hear from paul de camp now about their proposed fiscal agent and partner application with odu well good good good morning yes good morning good morning uh to president creasy uh dr coombs and the board uh my name is corey mccray i am the president of

[02:26:58] paul decamp community college and and let me just ask your forgiveness for being on the road I'm pulling over to do this presentation, but this is very important to us at RVCAM because of what this will do for the students in the Isle of Hawaii and the western groundwater space.

[02:27:19] We are putting forth our last school, which is the Maritime Trades Academy, Industrial Maritime Trades Academy. This is important for the students in our region because, as you know sitting in our backyard is the largest industrial based employer in virginia and that is newport news shipyard you may also know that the shipyard has to build up to three has to have at least 350 ships uh and it's uh put out for the navy in the coming years well the only way to do

[02:27:57] this is to engage with the region the k-12 space and higher ed space to actually train up those employees uh they're going to need 20 000 employees in the next five to ten years this provides a real opportunity for students in the western tidewater space to have a career that is sustainable uh without leaving home we you know we know that lots of students will leave virginia we want to keep up here and so the way we're doing that is by partnering uh with newport news

[02:28:31] shipbuilding uh olive white schools and the other k-12 schools in the western tidewater region to provide a career pathway for students to earn uh to have careers in the maritime space and so through our partnership with old dominion this is going to it's a it's a natural fit and we've worked with the odu uh as our largest transfer of institution for years now we're working obviously in the education space but we've done work with them in the healthcare space and continue to do so now we're also engaging with our skilled trades areas as well and so for

[02:29:11] our students who come through the imtpa they will have the opportunity to earn credentials get them immediately employed in the maritime space also earn a technical studies associate's degree with an opportunity to go on at Old Dominion and transfer for higher education and life. So we're excited

about this opportunity. We are very excited about continuing our long-standing partnership with Old Dominion University, again, as one of our largest transfer institutions, but continuing to grow in the ways that we partner in the Western Tidewater space.

[02:29:50] I do want to extend an appreciation to Old Dominion University for their work with us, their willingness to work with us. This is again yet another way that we can ensure that students have strong career pathways towards success upon completion of the academy, high school, and moving on to ODU and while still having thankful employment. And so I'll stop there, but I first want to also thank ODU for their work with us as a fiscal agent and partner,

[02:30:24] and I want to thank the board for allowing us this opportunity to work with ODME University. Dr. Sanzo, do you have anything you would like to add there? I do. Yes, thank you. I just wanted to share, we have been talking early on about the way that we can partner because really their lab school and the one that we have in important areas are our complementary sides of the same coin looking at maritime but addressing different workforce needs in the region and so this will allow us to partner collectively engage with our partners collectively recruit around the maritime work and odu is also the in-region coordinator for the go-tech program

[02:31:04] for region 5 which is a natural pipeline into both of these programs and so this only helps extend the work that we're already doing thank you um both to paul de camp and odu for your collaboration and thorough review of the critical elements in this fiscal agent and partner application are there any questions from board members here on this application okay hearing none anything else paul de camp or odu on this particular application i will i will i will say

[02:31:42] that we're excited about uh what this does for for the lab school with the other with the now growing network of lab schools that we will uh work closely with and learn from the professional development opportunities and the like for staff with our lab school is going to be critical so we're excited that we're part of ODU and the network of lab schools that will be participants here thank you so much thanks to you both we're so grateful for this intentional and collaborative approach to this particular fiscal agent partner application again the board will be

[02:32:18] reviewing and deciding on your fiscal agent and partner application tomorrow in our regularly scheduled business meeting so again thank you for your intentionality in this application in such a short period of time um moving right along we will now go to roanoke college and their proposed fiscal agent and partner application with their partner ODU. Good morning, can you guys hear me?

[02:32:45] Yes, we got you. Awesome, awesome. So good morning, it's my pleasure to be here on behalf of Roanoke College's team. I'm Dr. Natasha Watts, the Executive Director for the Roanoke College Lab School Explored RC, which was approved on April the 25th. So just a quick recap of our program, Explored RC is meant to be an immersive on-campus experience for 10th to 12th grade students in three career pathways, education, global studies, then health care and communication, civic engagement.

[02:33:15] Our goal is to ensure the program allows students to develop critical thinking skills while building bridges to the workforce needs of the Commonwealth. And we have a strong emphasis on inquiry and problem based learning. Part of our vision was to expand opportunities for students and faculty through networking, professional development, research and work based learning.

[02:33:33] We believe that ODU has a set of diverse resources and forward thinking approaches to education that can help us achieve this. ODU, of course, is known for leadership and innovative education, and we at Roanoke College are a very traditional campus, so we hope to learn through this partnership about ways to expand opportunities through non-traditional approaches.

[02:33:52] ODU has an incredibly long history in online learning that can be super beneficial for us to expand our reach to students in the Commonwealth. ODU also has the Monarch Communities Internship Academy, which can help our education, global studies, and our communication and civic engagement pathways.

[02:34:08] both strongly grounded in humanities frameworks and so through this partnership we're really hoping the internship academy could help us understand workforce needs with the humanities foundation the other thing we find incredibly um unique about this opportunity is odu just became uh just absorbed the eastern virginia medical school so our stem and healthcare pathways fit really nicely with those and we're really looking forward to the partnership and opportunities that it could bring both our students and our faculty network and be together we're also doing a portfolio assessment and a capstone course in our program we use using similar frameworks and so we're really

[02:34:44] hoping that this could be a beneficial research platform for us to better understand the student needs in the commonwealth that's one of the things i'm most excited about is what research that we can partner on and get through through sort of a research practice partnership so there's a lot of different avenues we're also really excited about the opportunity to have a partner across the state um we had a lot around us but to partner with someone across the state is going to give us a really unique viewpoint that we haven't had otherwise and so it's a mutually beneficial for us we really think it's about a good share and that's kind of it dr sanzo do you have anything

[02:35:22] you'd like to add here i i do and um you know it's been really a pleasure being able to talk with Dr. Watson and her team and thinking about the ways that ExploreRC has been designed and the alignment with our work. I mean she's already covered all of the different ways that we can connect and partner. I know for our graduate students who are looking for innovative researchable opportunities this is really going to be a very nice fit and it is definitely complementary to our merger with EBMS, our exciting Mellon, the humanities internship work that we have as well.

[02:36:02] And for us, with our different lab schools, as we look at pathways and the ways that we design pathways and ensuring that we're meeting student needs, I think it's going to be really important for us to partner and collaborate to learn from one another as we iterate and scale up the design. So, yeah, I think it's been a very exciting, ongoing conversation.

[02:36:20] Thank you both. We really are grateful to receive this overview and your application for a fiscal agent and partner. And the board will again be reviewing that tomorrow during our business meeting. So finally, we're going to hear from Emory and Henry College on their proposed fiscal agent and partner with ODU.

[02:36:44] Just want to make sure that you can hear me. Okay. Yes. Great. Well, good morning. Uh, almost afternoon, I guess, President Creecy, Superintendent Koons and board members. My name is Dr. Lou Fincher, and I currently serve as the senior vice president at Emory & Henry and Dean of our School of Health Sciences and effective on August 1 will assume the position of interim president here at Emory & Henry University.

[02:37:13] I am honored to speak on behalf of Emory & Henry and our lab partner, lab school partners. Our lab school was formally approved by the board on April 25th, and just as a reminder, the Southwest Virginia Healthcare Excellence Academy Lab School, or HEALS as we refer to it, is designed as a sustainable, grow our own healthcare career pipeline, really looking to increase the awareness of career pathways for students interested in healthcare careers,

[02:37:43] While also addressing the dire healthcare workforce shortages here in our region, our lab school partners, we had, we have quite a large partnership field, our lab school partners include for K12 school divisions here in Southwest Virginia.

[02:38:00] includes Smith County, Washington County, Wythe County, and the City of Bristol, as well as the Linwood-Holton Governor's School, Wytheville Community College, Virginia Highlands Community College, and the Southwest Virginia Higher Education Center, which will also serve as an instructional site for our HEALS courses. And of course, we are now excited to partner with ODU, both as our fiscal agent, but also as a valued educational partner, and the added advantages of being able now to partner with all of the lab schools within this new network. As a reminder,

[02:38:37] our program is so important to the kids in our region because of the increased college preparation and readiness for healthcare careers and the real world exposure they gain from healthcare professions and healthcare professionals through clinical shadowing opportunities in healthcare settings. And their instructional coursework will provide them with a strong foundation and the health-related sciences, but also introductory coursework in the healthcare field.

[02:39:07] We are excited again and eager to collaborate with ODU as our fiscal agent and partner to implement our innovative healthcare-focused lab school. The fact that ODU is serving as the fiscal agent for their own lab schools, as well as now the five additional lab schools, allows for such synergy and collaboration across all of these lab schools. And this has been mentioned by each of the other partners this morning. ODU is a strong fit for the HEALS program for a variety of reasons. First, they developed all their strong academic programs

[02:39:44] in health care and, of course, as has been mentioned, their recent merger with Eastern Virginia Medical School. But ODU has also been a partner in Southwest Higher Education Center here in Abington, Virginia, for over 20 years. And again, this center will serve as an instructional site for our Heals students. There's so many great benefits that come from this partnership, many of them have already been discussed, but just the synergy from the network to be able to be a part of this network and learn from our colleagues in the other lab schools, be able to identify the

[02:40:23] best practices and establish research information that can really help broaden and expand and strengthen the education the students receive from all of the lab schools. To be able to convene annually and to be able to meet with innovative K-12 schools and then be able to partner with higher education institutions is just going to be a great benefit. The ability to be innovative and scalable and be able to create sustainable educational practices that benefit K-12 and

[02:40:57] higher education is a great opportunity and just the fact that we can again be part of such a network and clearly ODU has the experience in developing networks like this which will only benefit our students and their educational experiences and so with that I want to say a special thank you to Old Dominion University and the board for providing opportunities for our students in our region to participate in our health care focused life school thank you dr

[02:41:31] sanzo do you want to add anything here as well yes please thank you so so for us at odu i think it's an ideal time for us to engage in a partnership the odu evms integration brings to the commonwealth of virginia the most complex and largest academic health sciences initiative and this partner partnership i believe will really serve as a model of preparation for health related sciences and those programs and the the possibilities for our k-12 students through this partnership and other partnerships will just yield powerful outcomes and help to ensure the

[02:42:08] quality the quality and the long-term viability of the lab schools and i can't emphasize enough how powerful networks and communities of practice are and helping to ensure that long-term viability just thank you for the opportunity and i want to express my thanks to the partners as well i mean They have been just a pleasure to engage with.

[02:42:27] And I've learned so much, and I'm really excited to just personally and professionally. Thank you all so much. Are there any questions from board members here on this particular application? Ms. Holton? Yes, I have no question, but just a comment, if I may.

[02:42:50] But just by way of clarification, I do think it's worth making clear that that the General Assembly's position would be not that they changed eligibility requirements in the budget, but rather that they provided a pathway for the community colleges and private institutions that were previously did not have access to the funding pathway to have access to the funding pathway. And I realize there may have been a difference of opinion on that, but just want to note for the record that the position of

[02:43:26] the general assembly i think would be that they did not create a new uh eligibility requirement or did not change the eligibility requirements not that i don't think we need to resolve that difference today but just noting the difference of opinion i appreciate that but they put a june 30th deadline they put a june 30th deadline on this so i do think that um they're i don't think either of us should be interpreting their motives so but the june 30th date i think speaks for itself

[02:44:02] miss holton okay um okay thank you so much to i'm sorry dr coons i just want to thank you again karen and odu i think one of the things we work on at the department is thinking about networking and spread whether it's early literacy work or early childhood we have always worked on networks and i just tremendously appreciate your expertise your background that you bring to this and your willingness to bring people together to help the things that are happening in lab schools be available to all students across the commonwealth so thank you so much for your leadership dr siebert

[02:44:40] i you know as a practitioner i love it when an elegant solution presents itself you know last month we were wrestling with this and what would come and how to go about things and so we wrestled and then practitioners in the field uh just solved and so i'm really excited i think what we've heard throughout this uh this approach and odu stepping up to the plate is not only will there be um best practices and sharing but you know some of the other concerns that have been raised in the past involve the sustainability i think what you're going to see achieved here in the years ahead is a critical mass uh critical mass of these organizations and

[02:45:19] the sharing uh that you know excellence will be get excellence and and i think that will that will actually help create um help the flywheel move faster it'll create some economies of scale um you know one of the one of the challenges sustainability of smaller efforts is you know people who wake up every day thinking about these things and when you when you have an organization a group like this um there's going to be uh there's going to be there's going to be opportunities for sustainability and and so the

last thing i would say is that you know one of the things that i was worried about as some of these more rural geographic impacts were at risk was you know what what are we going to do about that geographic impact what i thought was so necessary well now

[02:45:58] i'm thankful now i still maintain the geographic impact but we've now created a commonwealth-wide perspective and so i'm very excited and look forward to supporting this tomorrow further comments or questions here okay so to wrap this one up thank you so much for the partnership between odu and emory and henry very excited to review and decide on this fiscal agent and partner application tomorrow during our regularly scheduled business meeting. Thank you so much for the work that you've put into this in such a short period of time. So furthermore here, I just want

[02:46:36] to thank everybody, ODU and all of their partners in this as they have robustly and comprehensively approached this fiscal agent and partner management in collaboration. The overview of the five institutions is a great reminder of the unanimous or near unanimous votes that the board previously made regarding your innovative lab school models some that are even opening this fall and we thank you for your remarks and expedient call to action to ensure that these programs are continued and able to provide unique and relevant learning opportunities to students across the commonwealth

[02:47:17] before we move to the presentation on um the aerospace academy of the eastern shore i just want to clarify with everybody on the board that the as i reviewed the agenda again the following votes will occur tomorrow voting on all of the five institutions we just heard from and their their fiscal agent and partner applications we have an additional lab school that came out of committee for this their meeting last this month i guess it was on june 6th so 10th it is still june um and

[02:47:53] then finally to determine monetary awards the carryovers from last month that or from our special meeting in may i shouldn't say last month um so those things are there for tomorrow okay um so i believe we will now turn to presentation on odu's aerospace academy and i would like for dr Armstrong to come forward and give a brief introduction. I know this is going to be a little interesting with our tech setup over here. Okay, good. We can just turn it around.

[02:48:32] Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Nuttall. Good morning, Madam President and board members. On behalf of the Virginia Department of Education, I would like to provide an overview of the Old Dominion University Aerospace Academy of the Eastern Shore, AAES, lab school proposal, which is a partnership among old dominion university eastern shore community college acomac county public schools and northampton county public schools i would like to again thank the members of the college partnership lab school standing committee which includes our chair mrs joan wadiska virginia board of education members mr bill hansen and mr andy rotherham and members mr john

[02:49:11] bailey and dr pam moran for their time their feedback and commitment to lab schools and the additional opportunities afforded by lab schools on behalf of the students in the commonwealth and i do want to take a moment to thank the agency as well this initiative has affected every office within our agency everyone from the planning grant review committee to the subject matter experts to the folks processing grants so i do want to make sure i extend a thank you to the entire video for all their work to establish our lab schools upon receipt of a lab school application the video we does convene a subject matter expert team to provide detailed feedback in each compliance-related

[02:49:49] section of the application. The goal of the Application Review Technical Expert Committee is to document the needed technical expertise and provide counseling to the applicants to identify and correct

any potential deficiencies in the planning and implementation of the proposed College Partnership Laboratory School, determine compliance with state law or regulation, highlight potential problems or red flags with information contained in the application, and to identify aspects of the proposal that are especially exciting or unique.

[02:50:17] That subject matter expert team includes me, Ms. Shawna LeBlanc from Licensure, Mr. Jason Ellis from the Office of Accountability, Mr. Rebecca Askew from the Office of Policy, Mr. Ed Lanza from the Office of Budget and Finance, Ms. Melissa Velasquez from the Department of Policy and Communications, Dr. Sam Hollins from Special Education Student Services, Dr. Dave Myers, Ms. Claire Bremner, our Innovation Coordinator, Ms. Sophia McDaniel from our Office of Innovation, and Dr. Michelle Wallace from the Office of Instruction. Each subject matter expert was provided with laboratory school criteria checklist worksheets, and areas of expertise were assigned to these staff members subject to their education

[02:50:55] expertise at the agency. The compilation of these comments is included in the completeness and compliance report that you will see on the agenda for tomorrow. The completeness and compliance report corresponds to the lab school application and reflects the following dimensions of compliance. the Executive Summary, Mission and Vision, Educational Program, Governance, Management Structure, Financial and Operations, Placement Plan, and other assurances.

[02:51:18] The ODU-AAES application presented to you today has undergone multiple phases of subject matter review. Additionally, the agency has engaged the Office of Attorney General and the Governor's Transformation Office to ensure that applications presented to the Board and to the Standing Committee previously are complete and compliant and that budget and sustainability plans are scrutinized for efficiency and effectiveness in the use of lab school grant funds and the higher ed partners' detailed plans to sustain the lab school past the grant fund window.

[02:51:49] You will find cover sheets from the OAG and VDOE as well as consistent budget templates in the application which reflect these additional efforts taken on behalf of the applications for your consideration. The ODU-AES application was presented to the Standing Committee on June 10, 2024 and was approved on first and final review to be forwarded to the State Board today for your consideration.

[02:52:10] Joining me today from Old Dominion University is Dr. Karen Sanzo, the Director of the Institute for Design Thinking and Leadership Development at ODU. And upon completion of this report, I will invite her to provide a brief overview of their proposal and to introduce any other special guests in attendance to support AAES.

[02:52:27] AAES is proposed to create a pipeline to prepare workers for the aerospace and adjacent industries identified as priorities by the GO Virginia Region 5 Economic Development Authority as an innovative interdisciplinary school and the regional standard of excellence in preparation for the high-tech jobs in these high-growth fields.

[02:52:44] ODU and their partners, ESCC, Acomac, and Northampton, have presented a quality proposal that represents significant support and cooperation from among higher education, K-12 public education, and a variety of industry and philanthropic partners present in the aerospace networks that continue to grow on the Eastern Shore of Virginia, many of whom we will speak today on behalf of the lab school application.

[02:53:06] This proposal represents the beginning of an educational program that aspires to adapt to the needs of the aerospace industry and the unique communities of Acomac and Northampton counties through support of K-12 students and responsiveness to workforce demands. AAES is slated to begin operations in 2025-26, which provides a year of startup activities to ensure thoughtful and deliberate application of the proposed curriculum, facilities and technology improvements, and cultivation of these emerging partnerships.

[02:53:35] The proposed lab school is an innovative interdisciplinary lab school model that gives students career exposure through real-world problem-solving in collaboration with higher ed professionals, pre-service college students, and industry experts. AAES seeks to develop well-rounded students by providing both the fundamentals of aerospace technology coupled with emphasis on critical thinking, ethical considerations, and developing strong communication skills.

[02:53:59] Students will remain enrolled in their homeschool division while being provided with several options to engage in career exploration, including innovative aerospace-focused curriculum with distinct pathways in aerospace engineering and in cybersecurity and IT, which is a critical need in aerospace. Additionally, AAES has engaged aerospace partners to provide summer and extracurricular opportunities to extend learning.

[02:54:20] The interest from partners for this lab school application is exceptional and is hoped to nurture further growth and support for ODU and the partner divisions as they create additional future pathways responsive to aerospace workplace needs on the eastern shore. We received the ODU application on May 29, 2024, and prior to and subsequent submission, the agency has collaborated with the applicant as follows. Prior to submission, we held technical assistance calls between the DOE and this team on April 15, April 18, April 29, May 21, and May 28. Following submission of the application, a technical assistance call was held on May 30, and we conducted an on-site visit to

[02:54:58] Eastern Shore Community College that included representatives from ODU, Eastern Shore, Northampton, Acomac, the VDOE, and the Transformation Team on May 7, 2024. The first round of counseling from our Subject Matter Expert Review Team was provided to the applicants on May 31, and a revised application was submitted to the VDOE on June 3, 2024. The applicant was responsive to SME feedback and questions and provided their edits to the application and addendums as required to meet compliance. The ODU team presented to the standing committee on June 10th, responded to the questions of the committee, and was approved by the standing committee on June 10th to proceed to

[02:55:35] today's session of the BOE for review in anticipation of consideration for approval at tomorrow's business meeting. The ODU AAES application was posted for public comment following the June 10th standing committee meeting on June 10th and remained available until June 20th. One comment was received from Dr. Jim Schaefer of Eastern Shore Community College, who stated that aerospace lab school is a great addition to the eastern shore because it will create aspirations on the part of our students to become part of the aerospace industry and will provide the foundation for our students to go into good jobs and great careers and on behalf of the videoe i submit that

[02:56:10] the odu aerospace academy of the eastern shore application is compliant and ready to implement and i recommend to the board that the lab school be approved at tomorrow's business meeting and subsequently begin the contract approval process and to share more about odu aes i am again joined

today by dr karen sanzo a not unfamiliar face for you all at this point who will provide additional information introduce guests and attendance on behalf of aes and answer any questions from the

[02:56:37] board dr sanzo go right ahead great thank you let's pull up my presentation should be able to see it okay great so um a good afternoon i think it's almost noon again president crazy superintendent and members of the board. It is nice to speak with you again. And I'm also appreciative to my partners joining me here today in support of our lab school proposal, the Aerospace Academy of the Eastern Shore. Virginia is a burgeoning home to the aerospace industry and the state's aerospace

[02:57:15] unmanned systems industry workforce is projected to grow by 8.5% during the next decade with an economic impact of greater than $2 billion on the Eastern Shore. The establishment of the Aerospace Academy of the Eastern Shore in Acomac and Northampton counties where the poverty rate exceeds 40% in the past two decades have seen an aging and decrease in population can significantly contribute to the region's economic growth. An educated and trained workforce can help bring the aerospace supply chain business, can help bring more aerospace supply chain businesses to the Eastern Shore. And this is a strategic response to a critical workforce need in our community, and we're directly aligning with regional economic trends and

[02:57:54] job market demands. Our educational approach for the aerospace academy is aligned with our overall ODU lab school approach and continues with our focus on an innovative and research supported design that also provides a training ground for aspiring and current educators. In partnership with our districts, education industry and others, we plan to utilize student guided learning, STEM integration and experiential learning to equip students with the skills needed for highest demand aerospace industry jobs. Students in the academy will attend from their home schools, attending in-person and virtual courses. Throughout their high school experience,

[02:58:32] students will have opportunities to participate in site visits and other experiential learning opportunities in order to engage with and be prepared for aerospace industry careers. Students in the aerospace academy starting in ninth grade and launching in fall 2025 with an additional grade added on each year we'll have two pathways aerospace information and security systems or aerospace engineering and exploration additionally in the aerospace engineering and exploration pathway students can specialize in aerospace engineering and computer science or an unmanned air aircraft and geospatial technology we've been engaging with business and industry

[02:59:09] partners to understand the workforce needs in the aerospace industry and the response has been overwhelming with partners who want to be involved with this lab school and we've been ideating around innovative learning opportunities for our students during the design phase we've connected with these industry professionals to think about powerful learning experiences and students will have an opportunity to earn dual enrollment credits through the eastern shore community college as well as odu specific credits we're designing the school in a way that provides students with work-based experiences and opportunity to network with potential employers our students and lead the

[02:59:45] academy college and career and citizen ready contributing to a thriving aerospace industry and this represents our commitment to our students futures to our communities economic health and helping to cultivate virginia's aerospace industry our budget represents a need to provide innovative and robust educational programming for students including summer learning experiences experiential learning and in-person virtual learning opportunities we also anticipate in the upcoming year and in subsequent years

to focus on have time around curriculum development learning design and designing our implementation into the program because of the uniqueness of this learning design we tend to bring in together different partners as we iterate around this in our instructional

[03:00:25] approach our odu lab school network design has focused squarely from the beginning on sustainability as shared before in previous session presentations odu has a strong history of sustainability of initiative leveraging our research to demonstrate the innovations we want to continue as we move into our self-funded years we can continue to intend to continue to pursue grants our education preparation program has over a decade of ongoing grant funding to support educator development that will leverage and we have already begun discussions with potential partners to explore the ways in which they can assist with site visits out to wallops island to engage in summer camps with

[03:01:01] the virginia space flight academy with the virginia space grant consortium and to think about the ways that our partners can help with sustainability areas we're also working with our development office to identify key stakeholders that will be able to contribute financially as well as through human capital and other avenues such as field-based experiences internships and mentors ODU is committed significantly to investing in our lab school efforts including providing personnel resources fiscal commitments and technology in order to ensure the sustainability of our lab schools as you can see here these are our metrics but they're just the beginning we want our students to graduate having earned college credits to having internship or other work-based

[03:01:41] experiences and to graduate and then enrolling secondary education joining the military joining the workforce we want our students to be college career and citizen ready we are firmly dedicated to cultivating robust teacher educator pipeline and we want to continue our focus on generating research that will focus on inter-organizational collaboration effectiveness of lab schools teachers and professional learning student learning engagement and college and career readiness i thank you for the opportunity to share about our proposal and we have different partners who

[03:02:16] are here to offer their support as well is it okay if i call if i introduce our partners please okay great thank you so let me pull up our list here and partners if i do not recognize you also please let me know and feel free to chime in. But I'm going to invite Chris Carter to speak first. I'm just going to go down my participant list here.

[03:02:38] Chris Carter: Thank you, Karen. Good afternoon. I'm Chris Carter. I'm director of the Virginia Space Grant Consortium. Virginia Space Grant is a member of NASA's National Space Grant College Program, and our consortium consists of five Virginia universities, the Virginia Department of Education, Virginia Community College System, NASA Langley Research Center, and NASA Lawlap Slot Facility, and other members of a strong interest in aerospace and STEM education workforce development and research. We provide free STEM programs to students, educators, and researchers to build the STEM pipeline for the state of Virginia.

[03:03:14] Virginia Space Grants supports the Aerospace Academy of the Eastern Shore being led by Old Dominion University and in partnership with Acomy and Northampton County Public Schools. We can be a strong partner in proposal development in the pursuit of funding opportunities to sustain this program and we offer several high school student programs that specifically aligned with the vision and vision of the academy, including the Virginia Space Coast Scholars, Virginia Aerospace Science and Technology Scholars, and the Virginia Earth System Science Scholars.

[03:03:44] All three of these programs focus on increasing students' aerospace-related STEM knowledge and curiosity. Through online modules, students are encouraged to grow their creativity in designing new concepts in aerospace and NASA-related missions. VSGC will include aerospace academy students in these virtual courses offered during the academic year. For professional development, we'll provide educators training in the aerospace sector workforce needs and career pathways that can be leveraged by the academy staff and partnering school divisions. Two of these programs include bringing space to the CTE classroom, a partnership with ODU, and student

[03:04:21] tech SWAT educator training, a partnership with NASA Laws. We can offer spots in these workshops for academy staff and teachers in support of this lab school. And lastly, Virginia Space Camp can provide students with three experiential hands-on summer academies hosted at both NASA centers in Virginia. And Dr. Rachel White will be leading our partnership in this. She is our assistant director and has experience serving as the administrative director of a Governor's STEM Academy in Virginia Beach. And we thank you for your time and

[03:04:54] consideration. Thank you. Next on my screen is Joyce Winterton. Hello, I'm Winterton. I'm the senior advisor for education and leadership development here at nasa wallops flight facility i'm very happy to report at 5 30 this morning we had a beautiful sounding rocket launch with 50 experiments built by undergraduate students including eastern shore community college and it's fascinating old dominion university is doing 3d printing so the rocket just got back they're de-integrating it so i'm anxious to go see that they get so excited about being your

[03:05:33] science data back and that's the kind of real world authentic experience we will build on and we really need this aerospace academy of the eastern shore lab school because there is such a critical need for this aerospace pipeline students here on the eastern shore will be able to prepare for a broad range of opportunities in the aerospace industry with nasa and our partners and have great paying jobs and have jobs that will allow them to be feel rewarded and travel around the world so this really is an essential uh component of what we need to build

[03:06:10] our future workforce and pipeline so we're looking forward hopefully uh to supporting this and we also have two educators from appinac county here on site this week doing the wallops rocket academy for teachers so they're going to take that how to build rocketry physics science and that real world application of academic courses and of course we've got 40 virginia space co-scholar students high school scholars around virginia arriving on monday and i can guarantee every one of our employees at wallops thinks this is the best summer ever when they get happy students

[03:06:43] on side they said today it helps reinvigorate them and help them realize what exciting jobs they have so thank you that's so cool thank you i appreciate it karen taylor hi good afternoon i'm karen i'm the executive director for secondary school cpe and state and federal grants for affernat county i apologize our superintendent had an appointment so she wasn't able to be on our zoom today but i will say we're very excited we're always looking forward to new opportunities especially

[03:07:19] for growth within our school division and any opportunity we can to offer new things for our students as joy said she's actually on my ct advisory committee and we've had a great partnership over the years with NASA and it's great to see that we're getting more and more partners and more and more opportunities for our kids. If you were to survey quite a few of the employees currently at NASA our

students parents already work at NASA so it's nice to see you know some of the parents are retiring and their kids are actually going in as new employees. I can say as

[03:07:52] a former student of Alcomac County I did my senior internship at NASA in their accounting department so it's so many great opportunities for our kids here on the eastern shore um including the north hampton county and us doing this together so we are very happy to come forward to this new opportunity and give them great thank you so much and um dr martin um oh there you are on my screen

[03:08:21] yes hi good afternoon thank you everyone we're we um i am dr lisa martin the proud superintendent of north hampton county public schools joining me this afternoon is dr ken buda who is our coordinator of workforce and career technical education we in north hampton county are extremely excited about the opportunity for the aerospace academy of the eastern shore because as um dr sanzo shared with you we're looking at this is a great growth opportunity and as we sit on the

[03:09:00] south end of the eastern shore we recognize that much of this will be transitioning down into our community as well and so we're looking at this opportunity to enhance the stem skills of our students by actually giving them the applicable the relatable and actually the hands-on learning experiences that they so deserve to make stem learning and stem skills come to life for them we're also looking at the opportunity to continue to inspire the innovation and the creativity and within our students but most importantly as well as preparing them for life after school after

[03:09:35] school we're looking at this as an opportunity for um career opportunities to enhance the economic development of northampton county as well as after that county but also we look at this as a great opportunity for us to support our friends at the wallops space flight complex and the mid-atlantic regional spaceport so we are very excited and we look forward to this opportunity if we are so approved thank you thank you and i think the last person we have is kim check good afternoon i am

[03:10:12] calling in with limited service uh in the wallace region so i hope everyone can hear me clearly i'm kim check the executive director of the virginia spaceflight academy located at wallace island we are a long-standing provider of stem education with a strong aerospace and career pathway lean in both northampton and acomet county schools and we are obviously in full support of not only this proposal but continuing the work that we've already established in the school districts um we are in our 26th year of serving local students through our residential space camp

[03:10:50] at wallace island as well as the third year of implementing our year-round stem academy in the schools that also focus on aerospace engineering computer science and physics our curriculum is uniquely positioned to enhance the objectives outlined in this proposal and provide lab school students with unparalleled access and seats to our space camp every summer and continue their summer learning as to continue their summer learning as well as supporting students

[03:11:24] during the academic school year through our stem academy modules all of which continue to reinforce what all of these partners bring to the table to connect those real world applications and exposure to diverse workforce opportunities in both locally here at wallops and throughout the state of virginia with your support of this proposal and the power of the existing partnership within this wallets aerospace ecosystem this group will be able to provide students with a comprehensive and unparalleled aerospace education and inspire students to pursue

[03:12:03] a career within the state of virginia thank you for your consideration of this proposal thank you did i miss any partners that are on okay i think we have all spoken thank you thank you dr sanzo and all of the partners that participated here today i'm so excited about this unique and innovative opportunity that you've brought here to us for students in that area of the commonwealth and we're just really excited to see how this proposal continues to grow and

[03:12:41] develop over time because i think it's really amazing are there any questions by board members just a reminder that this is your time for questions so or discussion on this particular item dr northern yeah i am so excited about this and i can see kids just jumping at the chance to be a part of this lab school i guess my question for you is how are you guys thinking about you know just the level of interest you're going to get from kids are you thinking i mean is there

[03:13:18] some lottery based you know approach in mind or how are you going to deal with um with heightened interest of what i assume is going to occur when this is rolled out which is a good thing and um so so i think sorry it's a little bit difficult to hear so you're you're asking about the level of interest from students and then how we might address if there are more students interested that's right yeah so um you know i i've thought about that quite a bit we put forward our proposal with 50 students right now i i think i think we're going to get a lot of interest with

[03:13:57] this and i can defer to my division colleagues to speak to that a little bit more if they want to what what i feel is that we have generated so so i do think we'll get more interest than what we'll have the seats but i think we're also tempering up with the realistic expectation of implementation thinks 50 is a good number just to start with what we have been doing is working with potential partners already and thinking about potential funding models if we do have the opportunity to add in additional seats that are beyond the funding through the grant because i think that's

[03:14:36] one of the things that we want to be mindful of is are we looking at adding more seats down the road especially because we have this virtual potential option that's one of the pieces that we were going to study too is looking at the ways in which we engage with that broader um with a with a wider footprint which is why the partnership with mountain gateway is so intriguing and holds a lot of potential um so so again i'll i'll defer to my district colleagues around current interest um but we're already being mindful of longer term again with what the funding is going to look like the seats are going to look like a partnership with those who've already

[03:15:13] spoken here today i think speaks to our ability to expand our capacity one of the cases for example with virginia spacecraft distortion is we've already talked about offering an additional section of the training the courses that they provide for students so our students are going to be competing for seats we're able to provide these additional sections so students will have access to these classes from a university standpoint where we have a number of faculty that have the background and capacity to help support our partners in building up the curriculum

[03:15:49] and bringing on additional elements i think the other piece too is and this is a consideration that we look at across the spectrum with all the lab schools as we say we're coming in with one or two or three pathways but we also have built in the structure where we can change or modify or add-in pathways based upon division requests what our partner demands are as well um so i think

[03:16:12] we have built-in structures to expand capacity if needed further questions comments no okay going once going twice thank you dr samson say one thing okay it also comes down to us over the course

of the year to market and sell the programs. I will say it's such a large mile radius for Aspenack

[03:16:51] Northampton to be able to get from one end to the other that virtual classes have paid dividends for our students where we have had we have numerous teachers that are housed in one high school that teach out to all the other high schools in order to give all of our kids the equal opportunity for these dorm moment classes. But our counselors that we've spoken to already are very excited actually to go out and meet with partners of NAF that they haven't already met to actually be able to throw an avatar to the kids and be able to tell them you know these are the opportunities that are there but also we would like for some of our partners coming to our

[03:17:27] school to talk to our kids face to face uh Kim checked earlier about the summer camp the last several years we have been doing summer camps so some of those students are now high school kids that actually did the camp back in elementary and have been their way on up um and as she also said we have two of our teachers joey spoke about that one is at the middle school one's at the high school one teaches robotics one teaches chemistry and physics and they certainly promote these

[03:17:56] programs um that we are looking forward to thank you thank you anything else from your end dr sanzo Um, I, you know, I would just say that I think that this helps to enhance the work that we're already doing. And as I mentioned previously, I, I've really been blown away by the outreach and interest and engagement from partners who, who are aware of this proposal and I've already have reached out independently about bringing in additional resources to it. So, um, I'm excited

[03:18:35] and personally having started my career with a six year U.S. Department of Ed grant with northampton county i'm very excited about the potential to continue the work on the eastern shore it's a beautiful amazing community and to be able to provide these types of resources and opportunities to the students there and the families and communities um it's just a a great opportunity it's a it's as i mentioned it's it's just um it's an amazing community out there thank Thank you, and just for board members to know I know we may get a copy of this printed that we'll be distributing to you later.

[03:19:14] But we do, and it may be already in our public comment folder. But we received a letter of support for this lab school application from Stephen McCall, who is with Firefly Aerospace. So just make sure that you all take a look at that also.

[03:19:32] So thank you so much, Dr. Sanzo and space school team. We will be reviewing and deciding on the lab school, this lab school application tomorrow in our business meeting. So thank you so much for your thoughtfulness and your intentionality here.

[03:19:49] This is really exciting and a very unique opportunity for the students in the Commonwealth. And with that, I think I owe everyone a lunch break. Thank you so much.

[03:20:04] We will take a break until one o'clock, please. Thank you.

[03:20:10] With item C here, I guess we have Katie, you're going to tag team with Chad and Ann, or Chad and Ann are going to take this whole show over, huh?

[04:07:42] So we will be talking about our SS State Plan and school support framework performance categories here this afternoon, and then we will um have the opportunity for board discussion post presentation uh so please make sure you are jotting down your questions and comments as the uh can you hear me i'm sorry did i note her

[04:08:10] participation yeah yes i did yep um okay so um then we will have a obviously this item comes before the board tomorrow for a vote during the business meeting but please do have your questions and comments prepared for today's discussion thank you thank you so much it's great to be back with all of you again we have a long presentation but we're going to take it in chunks and there'll only be time to pause and ask questions throughout so you know but we wouldn't

[04:08:50] be talking about this work if we didn't begin with our guiding principles to ground this You know, these are not new to y'all, but we're really doing, this is the why we're doing this work. You know, we want to be sure that we're holding. Oh, yes. Mache, can you hear Anne at all?

[04:09:09] Okay. Yeah. So I think we need to move this over there. Thank you. It's coming in and out. Working on it.

[04:09:33] Is that better, Mache? Was that better? Sing out, please. You can tell me to talk. I hear some voices. Let's go. Okay. You need to be, like, on the day.

[04:09:53] It's close to the festival. Is that better? yes oh perfect okay all right we will move around the mic as needed um but i was just sort of starting off with the guiding principles for this work which we talked about at every single board meeting where we've brought this issue forward that we really want to be doing this work keeping an eye on holding high expectations for every student to create transparent and actionable information and to really emphasize you know not just sort of growth and proficiency but growth to

[04:10:26] growth to that proficiency standard um that we are taking into account stakeholder input and community input throughout the process so that this system is about building trust between schools communities parents students um you know it's not just putting out information but what do we do with that information to be sure that all of the learners in virginia are getting the supports that they need um we are sort of in the middle of the process now um as you recall this work began many years ago with a lot of discussion amongst the board we have now had sort of two big formal

[04:11:05] periods of stakeholder engagement across the state in every single superintendent's region and you know that sort of culminated in between those two with the board voting on a regulatory framework in march that is now out for public comment to develop a new school support system so it's sort of separate from the accreditation system this summer we are continuing to have stakeholder engagement we are getting comments on those proposed regulations that we'll talk about and then moving forward and the july meeting and into august and really getting to some of the details of the plan that is going to need to be submitted to the u.s department of education

[04:11:39] in the ssa state plan and then that's going to enable us to start collecting the data this coming school year so that in the fall of 2025 we would be able to fully implement the system so that's just a little bit about where we are in the process right now i have a question as to that slide can i the first go back to the timeline slide if i may

[04:12:06] Thank you. May I, Madam President? So just to be clear, as I understand this timeline, the plan is that the initial ratings under the new framework will be announced in the fall of 2025 based on school's performance in the 24-25 school year. Do I have that right, if all goes as planned?

[04:12:41] Yes. So that means that just for all of us to be clear that the 24-25 school year is not an experimental year or not a crossover year. It is year one in the sense that school's performance in the

school year that starts this fall will determine the school's initial ratings under the new framework that we are now working to finalize. Have I got that right? Yes, that's correct. So that this would be, we'd be using the 24-25 school year data to make those

[04:13:21] determinations in the 25-26 school year. So the 24-25 school performance data will determine initial ratings. So that means that we're really at the point where we are working to finalize between now and the beginning of the FY 24-25 school year, all the elements that are going to determine school's ratings so schools know what they're going to be graded on in this school year.

[04:13:49] Okay. Thank you. And, you know, there are certain pieces that are required to, you know, we'll address in the ESSA state plan. So that's kind of the plan, which gets into some of those details about, you know, describing each indicator, describing the overall system of differentiating school performance, as well as the types of supports that different schools will receive. So that's really why, you know, we need to do the regulations obviously first, But that state plan, which will be coming forward in July and then in August, that has to be submitted to the U.S. Program of Education includes a lot of those details.

[04:14:23] Madam President, we need to finalize the regulations. We need to finalize the ESSA plan. And we do need some kind of document that contains the state plan all in one fell swoop, right? I mean, not just the ESSA plan, the federal system, but the state system.

[04:14:44] Hopefully, we're going to have some kind of document that the school divisions can read and understand what our new framework is ready for them for fall of 2024. Yeah, so I would say that's sort of, I would consider that guidance documents. It might not be one document, it might be different documents, and I think that's something that the VDOE team would be building out based on some of the decisions that we're making today, making in August and July, so that, you know, a lot of the document, I would say the regulations and the ESSA plan itself are very you know they're quite technical and some people need that technical information but it's also important to communicate the changes in a higher

[04:15:22] level that the general public can understand so I think a suite of guidance that's sort of aimed at that different audiences will also be developed and I think that's part of what the team at BDOE is thinking about as far as the rollout of this but we have to get through um we had to sequence things in a certain order because it made sense to start with the regulations given the timeline to regulate in Virginia, the ESSA state plan, given that we know the U.S. Department of Education might have questions that we need to respond to. So we've tried to prioritize those actions and lay them out in this sequence. Okay, so today we already went through the vision and guiding

[04:15:58] principles in the timeline. That's going to review just some of the regulatory decisions that have already been made. And then the bulk of today's presentation is going to focus on six elements that are going to be building into that ESSA plan and also some modeling that we've done since we last talked to you in April. So that's talking about the performance categories for schools as well as the results of the modeling we did. And then really focusing on sort of four key indicators, the mastery index, the middle school measure that looks at advanced coursework taking, and then in high school, how we're measuring graduation rates, as well as ready for life.

[04:16:36] That's kind of the outline for today and Chad and I will take turns. So we're kicking things off just focused on sort of an overview of what we have done already. So as a reminder, this is the new framework that the board voted on in the regulations, which really split the accreditation system with the school support and performance framework on the left side. And this school performance framework is

going to be meeting both state and federal purposes. So rather than having two systems and two lists of schools that need support. There would just be one. The board

[04:17:13] obviously determined the big categories of indicators that would be included in that performance framework, focusing on growth, readiness, and mastery at elementary and middle school levels, and at the high school level, focusing on graduation, readiness, and mastery. That then feeds up into those performance categories, which we are going to discuss in a little bit in the presentation, as well as the really the federal support categories of schools that need that comprehensive support at the whole school level or schools that need additional support for a particular student group all aligned with the support that the osq team provides as well as federal funding for improvement the accreditation system on the other hand is really

[04:17:52] going to focus on more operational input components that are part of the soa so that's not just performance but looking at graduation requirements and course offerings and educator credentials in the school and you know schools will still be either fully accredited accredited with conditionally accredited or could potentially have their accreditation denied and that's really just to sort of meet those state statutory requirements the board has you know as i said voted already on those high level categories to be included at the indicator level achievement or mastery on state assessments growth and readiness and as well as graduation rate in high school

[04:18:32] the regulations also lay out sort of the weighting categories of between those three buckets and the fact that there would be four performance categories that those weights sort of roll up into unlike our current system where performance on a single indicator is what sort of determines the outcome in this case in this new system all of the indicators are weighted together to determine the result and that you know this is going to be braiding that federal system with the state system so that the video we can align their supports around a single system of schools that either

[04:19:08] need support for whole school challenges or for a particular student group so just a little update on the current status of those regulations they have been posted to the town hall for public comment that comment period closes in two weeks um as of june 10th this was not most recent we had only received one public comment through the town hall and this was actually related to the fine arts the particular creation of a fine arts diploma seal there was also a public hearing held on june 4th with 12 people providing comments and the majority of those comments were also focused on this fine arts diploma seal there may be additional public comments that come

[04:19:46] in we know often people wait till the last minute to submit comments so we will be back in july with an update i'm sure on the public comment period but this is what we've heard so far so i'll pause be sure no questions before moving on to the next topic which i think this is going to be the bulk of our discussion so our first category that we teed up for today is really focusing on the school performance and support framework categories which were you know part of the regulations that say there need to be four categories um voted in september of course to have some kind of summative

[04:20:25] rating measure to communicate the results of this new system to the public and then in april after the regulations had been approved and you know gone out for the public we held a series of listening sessions across the state all of the different superintendents regions and this was one of the topics that came up in every one of those listening sessions and we heard strong feedback from stakeholders as

which is well aligned with where the board is that they did not want to see an a through f type school rating or scale as part of this really felt like more descriptive

[04:21:00] category language would be better um in terms of public transparency in terms of really communicating where schools are i think that's also aligned with past discussions that the board has had and they really wanted that language also to reflect the type of supports that schools would receive be based on the data that we were seeing so as a result of that we're coming today with a proposal for four different performance category labels i just want to be clear here that the this is the sort of four big texts distinguished on track off track and needs intensive support

[04:21:36] the descriptive language below is just included as an example that's something that we can refine further on as we work with the board get additional feedback um and that sort of is a chance to really explain what those four categories mean in more detail um but the four categories proposed here are distinguished on track off track and needs intensive support one other sort of just contextual piece of information here is that the school support framework now being a weighted measure where it's not a single indicator that triggers identification

[04:22:11] it's sort of looking at all of these different data points in context we expect that some schools that are identified as needing federal support may not necessarily all be in that lowest category So schools are actually going to be sort of having maybe potentially additional layers to communicate the types of support they're receiving that are just different from those summative performance categories.

[04:22:35] So we saw sort of several different examples here of what that could look like. You know, if a school is identified for comprehensive support, again, they're getting sort of full school support, additional targeted support or targeted support are getting supports either at a more intensive level or sort of a lesser level for a particular group.

[04:22:52] So you see School A here is shown as maybe it's getting the on-track performance category and does not have any federal support. So the public would just see on-track. But, you know, take contrast that with School B, which is also on-track as its performance category, but has been identified for targeted support, say for their students with disabilities population.

[04:23:12] So the public might see on-track and then receiving student group support. So both pieces of information would be communicated publicly. Yes, Dr. Ames. Dr. Kunz. So my question is on this on track receiving student group support, would it identify the student group? So the federal law does require to say which student group is sort of the reason why a school has been identified for targeted support. So that is something that the public would see and be communicated. And it could be multiple groups. You might see a school that

[04:23:49] has been identified as needing to provide extra support to its Black students and to its Hispanic students, or to its economically disadvantaged students and its English learners. So to however many different groups would be included as well. I'm sorry. Ms. Holton? So two questions. I'll combine them. One is, am I right that the regulations actually said four or more categories, so we have not actually made a decision that we're going to have a four category it said at

[04:24:27] least four and so i i would submit that uh that question is still up uh for grabs and i've just looking at other other states that have a report on a summative rating i've seen ones with five ohio is one you've used they have nine uh i'm not sure i've seen anybody else with four and so my first question is why

four what's the rationale and that may be the right number but how are we deciding that four is the right number of categories what's the what's our decision

[04:25:01] making process that's led to that that's the first question and the second question is related and that is when and how and who is going to determine the lines between the categories so if if uh the The second category is on track and the third category is off track.

[04:25:21] One of the bigger decisions that needs to be made at some point is what is the dividing line between on track and off track? Like our current system has clear dividing lines for what meets the state standards for a school.

[04:25:38] So if you're at 75% on English language, 75% of your students are passing English language assessments, then you're on track basically. there's some nuance there, but it's basically 75% for the English language, 70% for math, science, et cetera. At some point, we've got to draw these lines, right? And who and how and when and on what basis are we going to do that? So I can speak a little bit. We might be previewing some of what Chad will talk about later, but I think one of the key things that we...

[04:26:10] And if it makes more sense to wait till later, I'm okay with that. Just a little preview, I mean, because we don't specifically address that question, But I think we have been starting to model the system, running all of the indicator data through, working with, you know, a vendor to help us do that so we can sort of project and see where different schools would fall if we weighted this indicator at this percentage.

[04:26:34] And, you know, putting in sort of different rules to see what the results look like in terms of that actual overall index score as well as, you know, which schools might be identified as needing support. Because the results, oh, sorry. Sorry about that. The results look different, you know, depending on the decisions that you make. If you weight an indicator more or less, or if you tweak some of the parameters, you might get different results. So that's one of the things that we are doing. And, you know, we want to be sure that we're using, for example, indicator weights that the board feels comfortable with.

[04:27:08] So then we could say, okay, now that we know what the indicator weights are, here's kind of what the overall system results look like. Here's the range of scores that we're seeing. And it might make sense to think about having, you know, a cut point here or there.

[04:27:24] So it's a process of we had to first run and model the system with making decisions about indicator weighting and things like that in order to even be able to come forward with ideas for what the overall picture might look like at the end of the day. That said, I think it would be helpful for us to have some input and ideas here around, you know, when you look at different states, they might have sort of their results of how they map schools onto their summative ratings or performance categories.

[04:27:51] it looks kind of like a bell curve, you know, a very similar number of schools are in the top category as they're in the bottom category. In other states, they might have a smaller group in that bottom category and the rate and the results are sort of skewed higher. If that's something where they have more schools, maybe lumped in the top three categories and in that bottom category, if there's a preference here, a discussion that the board would like to have about what makes sense, that would be useful guidance for Chad and I and the team to be able to then take back as we look at the data that we see in the models.

[04:28:25] Madam President, so just in follow-up, so that would be useful to have that feedback today because, I mean, if I understood the timeline discussion earlier correctly, we're going to be finalizing all of

this basically at our July meeting.

[04:28:40] So I think that July and August, I believe there might be an August, but I don't know. There is not currently an August meeting. Not currently, there might be an, okay. But yeah, so I think that we would be moving this forward toward the summer. I would say that I would always call that a preliminary.

[04:28:56] You know, there are always things that could happen. But I think that we would be in a much better position in July with some decisions and feedback here to give you all a good sense of how we're seeing the results play out and what might make sense. But it would be useful for us, I think, to know if there was a desire to say, you know, if this system comes back and we have 50% of schools in this category, that's not going to make sense to the public.

[04:29:22] You know, that's good and useful input for us so that we can be sure that when we are working with the data whizzes, that we can prevent that from happening by changing different parameters in the models. So what would be helpful to me if you need feedback from us on that today so that we can make decisions in July before the school year starts would be to have us learn something about what are the other states who are using these kinds of summative ratings doing?

[04:29:51] You know, so if you've got information you can share with us on options we should be considering, I think that would be helpful. So I think you definitely see, and I'm happy to say, like there's some states that do choose, I would say, probably most common from what I've seen.

[04:30:07] It's not a universal rule by any extent, but I do think that often that lowest category tends to be a little bit smaller than the others. I'd say that is common. So the ratings do tend to sort of skew more toward the high distribution as opposed to seeing that perfect bell curve, where you would have sort of a similar number in the top and the bottom.

[04:30:29] I've also seen, though, in many states, and again, like you mentioned, some might have six categories. There are different numbers of categories that there are some states that keep that top category also very small. You know, they want that to be a, particularly if they had, you know, six categories, they might say it's really hard to get that number one, but we have a lot of twos and threes, you know.

[04:30:51] So I think that that's where thinking about, I would say generally that bottom category is a little bit smaller. And, you know, depending on the number of categories the state has, they might also reserve that top category for sort of truly exceptional performance.

[04:31:08] And then my final question at this point, if I may, just is the, what's the basis for the recommendation that we have only four categories? Yeah, so I think, you know, you're right that the regulations do say at least four.

[04:31:25] So it's not saying four, exactly four, it says at least four. And I think this was based in part on the language that we heard from stakeholder input and the sort of types of systems and the types of language. when we presented this at the listening sessions that folks gravitated to, I think one of the examples that they really thought was the best, like really resonated with, had four categories.

[04:31:46] So I think that was one reason why that this came forward in that way. I will say, Ann, that is the case. We did have, in those listening sessions, there were examples that were provided for the public to see and comment on, and they did most often gravitate towards more of less um i think a more simplistic

so the fewer categories that there could be the better i do think that when it comes down to it it's really going to the the true meat of the

[04:32:22] matter is going to happen in how we set up those descriptors so everything that's underneath the descriptor how do we how do we truly articulate what's being um what what what are we looking for in each one of those so i think um that to me when i was in the listening sessions it was more not six eight categories let's do fewer but not too few so i just don't remember i remember seeing the presentations but is there a state that uses for that we would be looking at and can somebody

[04:32:57] remind me what state that would be we we looked at maine and we also looked at nebraska um in our documentation. We also, I just want to go back to our North Star, South Carolina. We looked at multiple states at four, but if we look at our number two, North Star, it's transparency and access to actionable information. So making this transparent and clear means simplifying it. So one of the pieces we heard during feedback was, as you're thinking about these words, as you're thinking about these categories, less is more, keep it simple, be clear. And so we heard that

[04:33:35] time and time again. So we heard making this easy to use, simple, and clear as hallmarks around that North Star and the translation into these categories. So I'll put a little finer point on it.

[04:33:52] Most states who use five ratings do it because they want an A, B, C, D, F, or they want a one through five stars. So that's the states that don't do the A through F or the stars or the whatnot tend to use the four data points instead of the five.

[04:34:17] Rotherham? Yeah, I'll echo what Dr. Northern said, but also what you've seen in some states, we even heard, and there's been so many presentations, I'm reluctant to credit who it was. We even had some experts in here who were talking about Ohio and nine is too confusing and some of the downsides of that. And in places that have gone to sort of full-on matrices and placemats, lots of categories, there's been concerns from civil rights groups, there's been concerns from education advocates.

[04:34:39] So, obviously, we don't want it to collapse to where it's not meaningful, but we can also get to a point where it becomes meaningless because everybody gets a designation for all intents and purposes. So, I think four or five, we're striking a balance, and I would second Dr. Norther.

[04:34:55] We can't have it both ways. If we don't want to do five, then there's going to be some tradeoffs. But the four versus five isn't determined. And I mean, I hear you five is meshes with A, B, D, F, A, B, C, D, F, but it could also be A, B, C, D, or it could be, in other words, if we want, we could still do four or five with descriptive categories.

[04:35:17] And I don't have a strong sense of which is right, but I think we should make that decision based on what we think is right. I think, I'm sorry, Dr. Northam, I mean, I do survey research.

[04:35:33] So when you have a Likert scale, five point Likert scale, right? what happens is when you land in the middle, right, it's the sort of the category where survey developers will then often collapse data points one and two and four and five so that the lay audience can understand it better. Because the one in the middle often is just taken out because it's like, okay, we don't know what to do with that, right? So I think the five point, even though pragmatically you would think it would offer you more distinction, it's so often collapsed at the bottom and the top, even in, in widely, I mean, in survey research, it's always usually like,

[04:36:10] do you very much like it or, you know, just like it? And then they'll combine those two together and then they'll combine strongly disagree and disagree together at the other end, for instance, so that people will have conceptually better understanding and they're not lost into whatever this smushy thing is in the middle. Yeah. So I think that, um, that's the four categories here.

[04:36:34] Obviously, it's not the only piece of information. We would also have that federal support category on top of that. And I think, you know, just given sort of the four categories itself, too, it might lend itself, you know, again, keeping in mind the current system, which does not do a good job of differentiating schools, where 90% of schools are given the same category, that's certainly something that as we model the data, we would be not wanting to replicate that.

[04:37:04] We do want this system to produce a much more full picture of school quality so it's not just a binary. And I think having the four categories laid out here will give us room to do that. We could certainly say that the needing intensive support category is a small category, but we might want to leave some wiggle room in the other three categories so we're not having 60% of schools in one group.

[04:37:28] We do want to see some differentiation. So I think these are all things that we will keep in mind as we move forward with some additional modeling moving into July. So tomorrow, during the business meeting, the board is going to review and vote on these summative rating categories.

[04:37:47] And then that is something that we're going to include in that SSA state plan draft. That's just a little bit about where this is heading. I skipped a slide, but this is where we are.

[04:38:02] Now I'm going to transition into modeling, and I'm going to turn it over to Chad. All right. Good to see you all. You all have been asking for data from the very beginning, so I'm excited.

[04:38:19] We actually have data to show you today on the full system. We're going to start with two models we had. We worked with SAS to run the models on all schools in Virginia. Two models are slightly different. So we're going to explain what's different about the two models.

[04:38:36] They're meant to give us information for give you all information as you give us feedback. the the results today will i'll be breaking them down by grade band also breaking them down by some of the different categories that are included in the system and then the plan is that once we have feedback on these first two models that will give us information to go forward and keep writing the ss state plan and to uh to miss holden's point to eventually have a technical

[04:39:06] workbook for divisions to work with. Okay. So why do we want the data? Maybe this is self-evident for folks who really like data, but this will help us make decisions about how to balance different indicators. We've decided on a blueprint at the high level, but there are other indicator level decisions that we still need to make that we've been talking about. So that will help us with that. It will also help us with some of the distribution questions that my colleague Ann was

[04:39:44] talking about earlier and in terms of both the distribution at the school overall as well as different subgroups and how to model and how to include them in this system so there's going to be i'm going to talk first about what was in the models and then i'm going to show you the results please stop me if you have questions along the way there are a lot of details and numbers in here so there's a lot of technical aspects to it what i'm going to show you will be i'm going to start by talking about the components though the high level uh indicator level and then i'll show the um uh what was in that model or what was in that indicator the definitions uh and then any other

[04:40:22] things that are included in it sort of the sub weights as well there like i said we ran two models so there'd be times when there were different weightings and what we did was try to give you a range so you could give feedback and sort of see how uh to weight different factors so the board voted uh to include the indices as a reminder the current system the state accountability system is an indicator based system so if a school is low performing on any individual indicator it can be flagged for identification for improvement purposes this

[04:40:57] is an index so it has waiting across different categories that will roll up into a total score for the school at the elementary school level the mastery is worth 65 points growth is worth 25 and the readiness is worth 10. middle school is slightly less mastery is 60 growth is 20 and readiness is 20 and then the high school mastery is 20 is 50 graduation is 15 and readiness is 35.

[04:41:27] i'm going to keep talking about what's in those buckets but just so you remember what is included in the system and the key point here is that it adds up to a total point the other thing to note is that the grade bands have different indicators in them which have different performance levels in them and so uh one thing that is very clear in the data is i think we're going to want to look at them as separate grade bands you're not going to want to compare a number that an elementary school has versus in high school and so they're going to be on a separate separate scale all the the total scores will be out of 100. There's some components where, based on the way that

[04:42:06] they're designed, they can get more than the full credit, but we're going to talk about that as well. So this is what you've seen before. This is the familiar diagram of how it looks like and the sort of the placemat approach for what it looks like. What's in the model for elementary school, I'm going to talk through that, is growth is vivos in reading starting in fourth grade. So it goes fourth through eighth, but for elementary, would be fourth through fifth. Readiness has the chronic absenteeism in this model. We weren't able to model any performance tasks. So just so we know, we've had that conversation in the past,

[04:42:44] but it's not included in the models that I'm going to talk about today. Mr. Rotherham? I just have a clarifying question because I've heard there seems to be some confusion. VVAS is in there as the growth because that's what we're using right now, but we are not linking like a future board could adopt a different growth model correct we're not anchoring in that into perpetuity or into it is our current vendor that we are currently under contract okay yeah so the regulation says uh that the new system will include year-over-year growth how much students grow from one to the next it doesn't say anything about sass or a particular vendor or

[04:43:23] anything like that okay i want to clarify there's been some confusion in the in the community about but yeah so the current uh i'm going to talk a little bit more about the growth so i'm going to put a pin in that and come back to when we talk about growth specifically yeah good question so this is all 2022-23 data so mostly spring of 23. uh we don't have the spring of 2024 data yet that will be something that we could use to decide cut points so the earlier conversation or maybe not

[04:43:58] even that yet all right so we're going to go a little bit deeper into the specific components of the system the mastery index uses a weighted index for the purposes of our modeling here we chose one of the models that we discussed at our last board meeting and so uh we're going to talk about this later if you we need to finalize exactly what that is but we chose to focus on this particular mastery index which gives 0.25 points for students who are below basic

[04:44:32] 0.75 for basic one for proficient 1.25 for advanced um and then for tests there are some tests that virginia has that only has three performance bands and for those they just use the top three uh numbers so they're the same numbers but just cuts off the other two bottoms the other thing to note is that they include the sol standards of learning tests they also include the the vap results the alternative assessment program so these are included in the mastery component as well the mastery also has multiple subjects so we've been talking about it as one

[04:45:11] high level but we also needed to figure out how to balance across different subjects and what we started with was using math and reading at a higher weight than science there are more kids who take the math and reading tests the science are only in certain grades uh and it's also more how other states do it is they have equal weight among math and reading and then science at a slightly less weight the one change between model one and model two is how we included english learner progress and so we started we tested it out at 15 as at the high end and we tested out five percent on the low end and so that is going to change how the results are and that's a big factor that we're

[04:45:50] going to talk about of uh the the results madam president just to clarify we haven't talked about the english language piece at any that i recall at any length but i assume that is a weta progress growth, WIDA growth measure. That's right. It uses the same growth measure that Virginia has been using in the past. That we're currently using. Okay. It's just how to weight it into the mastery index. And how does that work for schools that don't have significant percentages

[04:46:27] of English language students, or even, you know, it's a complex number because schools that have very small numbers don't have any number to use. And schools that have a little more than that, but not a lot it puts a whole lot of weight on a small number of students yeah that's that's right so um we had to set a minimum size for inclusion in the system uh and we varied that as well so we tested out a minimum of 10 which is very low and we tested out a minimum of 15 as well uh but yes you're right that there are schools that even then don't meet that minimum in size and so what that

[04:47:05] happens is then that way it gets reallocated to the other subjects so okay so it just gets reallocated so help us understand are you going to on a later slide and i'm fine with that help us understand you you need us to make a choice between 15 and 5 that's assume you need us to give you guidance on that today and what are the right what do you recommend the criteria are for helping us make that choice what are the implications of the two alternatives i i think what we asked them to do in modeling was do more of a goal post like what is a low number weight

[04:47:43] around l's what is a higher weight to give some ideas to the board so that you could give us directionality i don't think you're voting or making a final decision i think the team ran a really low number a rather high number so you could talk through today the goal posts around having that really low number and that high number. Yeah. The other thing I'll put a pin in and we'll come back to this is we have more to talk about of English learners and how they're included in the system. They are fully included in the system as the regulation proposes. And so we're going to talk about some of the implications of the different weights and gather your feedback

[04:48:16] on those things as well. Did you also reallocate the performance-based task or did you change the denominator so you wouldn't be dealing with it at all? The performance test is, we don't have a tests so we don't have a result so it's not included at all yeah okay so those okay so really we are still looking at 100 points but we didn't reallocate that 10 anywhere is what you're saying uh i'm not quite following the

performance test that we've talked about would be the introduction of a potentially new assessment in grades five and potentially eight that we've talked about

[04:48:56] at a board level but it hasn't been finalized and so that was not part of the okay we haven't we haven't allocated any percentages to that is that right okay dr coons no we asked for directionality last month within the readiness indicator where you wanted it to be because they didn't have any data they just modeled on on the chronic absenteeism yeah you're going to see this in what i'm talking about uh with the full model is we use what we had available so we uh look at things like the ccri the college career readiness index that we currently use is the data we used in in these models. We are going to talk later today of whether we want to make some changes

[04:49:35] or improvements to that indicator as well. But we used what we had to run these models. So, yeah, I hear you on what you've done the modeling on. But in terms of what decision points you need direction from us on, I think I'm hearing one of them is, are we deciding to use solely chronic absenteeism as the readiness indicator for elementary school for year one of the system? Or are we including some fourth or fifth grade assessment? And if so, what is that? Is that a decision element that's still outstanding?

[04:50:13] I'll give it to Dr. Coons. Our directionality is that you wanted to use the performance task in the readiness pieces. That is what our directionality has been from the board. Whether or not we are able to actually fully implement that for year one, we would have to get ESSA approval to do that, right?

[04:50:35] So that will be a part of the work, but we have not determined as in conversation, nor have we been given a vote on performance tasks should count 6% in the ESSA or 2%, but we are understanding from the last directionality from the meeting in april was that performance tasks should be included moving forward so so that means i hear you we're not asking for votes but direction out we need direction from the board again i think ideally today on what that performance task would be for elementary school

[04:51:13] and on what weight it will receive am i right is that later in the powerpoint do you guys bring that up later i'm just asking we don't have more on that in the powerpoint we model what was available. So most of today is on what we have so far. I don't know if that's right. One thing we did hear from the board was a suggestion last time of keeping chronic absenteeism as the same weight across grade bands. And so that is part of the current models today. So that would mean dropping any weight for anything other than chronic absenteeism in the elementary school readiness,

[04:51:56] because that's the 10% chronic absenteeism. So in other words, that's what's in the models today. yes and and what's in the model today is what's going to fold into the framework proposal unless we make some changes no chad said they modeled off of the data we currently have so for example he said they use cccri because that's the data we currently have he also said we don't have alternate performance tasks at this point in time so when the board asked us to model they

[04:52:34] modeled off the data that was available. They're showing in this slide what the data was available and what they used, not a signal that because the data is not available, we're not going to use it moving forward. So really, we've got two things going. Modeling, which I'm very excited to hear and is going to help us on decision making is one thing. But the other thing, I'm sort of trying to make a list of what are our outstanding decision points that we need to resolve soon in one fashion or another. And this elementary school performance task, what is it and what is its weight are

[04:53:09] outstanding decision points, if I understand correctly. I understand the answer. We didn't use them in the model because they don't exist yet. Got that. Yeah, thanks. So we jumped ahead a little bit. This is the readiness bucket of what's in the models today.

[04:53:26] The chronic absenteeism was included at 10% for all grade bands. And that is in the model, what we had available for elementary. For middle, we also have a middle school advanced coursework, which we're going to talk more about the indicator level and sort of the choices that we could add or adapt later. But for now, we used a model that we discussed last time, including advanced math in eighth grade. At the high school level, we use the current CCRI, which is the data we have available. And then we also modeled two different graduation metrics, completion metrics.

[04:54:03] So high school has the four year adjusted cohort that is already included. We also looked at two other potential completion metrics. One of those was the current GCI that we've been using in Virginia for 20 years and also another five year rate as well.

[04:54:19] So we looked at those implications too. We skipped growth. So just so I say it out loud for all of us, The growth has looks at elementary and middle school four through eight. And for some clear grade bands, it's easy.

[04:54:38] We in the first model, we used all the schools that had very clear grade bands of K five, six through eight and nine to twelve. The second model, we were able to add more schools that had different grade configurations. And oftentimes they were very similar. So they were easy to categorize into one of the elementary and middle grade bands.

[04:54:58] just so you're aware the uh we are using vivos in the current system it's whether a student meets their expected growth target for that year or not so it's a binary measure of whether they met growth or not uh it does not include the vap for the growth measure at this point in time we are working to try to add that over time excellent okay so here's how it's weighted uh for all the models we also had it weighted uh we we did it equally across elementary math and reading as as well as middle math reading.

[04:55:40] I mentioned this already. We included the graduation. All the models include the four year rate, which the board voted on. It's weighted at 15% in the models and it has the four year adjusted cohort rate, which Virginia has been collecting separately. We also modeled out other completion indices as well.

[04:55:58] All right. Now I'm going to give it over to Anne to talk about English learners and their inclusion. Are there any questions? You good? Okay.

[04:56:15] So I just wanted to delve in a little bit. in particular on the way that English learners are included in the new framework because it is one of the bigger changes potentially that's sort of maybe under the radar between the way the current accreditation system works and our current federal system so because we're switching now to one unified federal and state system what we're currently doing in the federal system is now going to be what's used throughout the system so just some context here is that you

[04:56:50] English learner performance has been a challenge for the Commonwealth over the last 20 years. You can see here the red line shows English learners. The gray line shows students who are non-English learners. The population has grown somewhat in that time from about 6.5% of students to close to 10% of students in the Commonwealth are identified as an English learner.

[04:57:13] But the achievement gap, the gap between our EL students and our non-EL students has grown significantly from 12 points to now 39 percentage points. So just sort of keeping this in context, as we are moving forward with this new system to have that one state and federal system, we are going to be including more English learners under the proposed regulations.

[04:57:40] the current accreditation system says that all English learners can be excluded from the accreditation system for five and a half years. So that means that a student who is an English learner in elementary school who is not proficient in reading or math and not making progress on their English language proficiency. So that's two different subjects. They take the reading and math test, but they also take an assessment that measures their acquisition of English language content. If a student is in elementary school and is not succeeding and not growing and not showing

[04:58:16] growth, they're just excluded from the system. They're not counted at all. Under the new system, the regulations, it will lower that adjustment period to one and a half years, which is consistent with federal requirements since 2001. Actually, this is not an ESSA requirement. This has been place for over 20 years at the federal level where all recently arrived English learners must be included in the accountability system in their second year. So Virginia has been significantly out of line with sort of the national standards for quite some time. And the majority of states do you know follow this rule as well. So by making this change we're now going to be including about

[04:58:56] 35,000 English learners who were currently excluded but are now going to be measured as part of this new system in terms of you know again our first north star principle high expectations for all students so i apparently i thought under our current system the english language learners were not their scores were not included up until the five-year level on the uh primary sols english and math but that they were that their wita scores and progress on wita scores were included all along

[04:59:35] am i am i wrong about that um so they i would say they can be included but only if they are making progress if an english learner is not making progress on the wita assessment they are excluded as well even up to five years okay so under the new proposal would another option be and i realize for federal purposes we have to account we have to do the year and a half which we do do now for federal purposes because we're required to but is there an option and we are deviating from and i i get our goal of unifying our state system to the federal system as much as possible but we

[05:00:14] are deviating in other areas already so it's not impossible to deviate would it be possible for us to include weta scores but not english and math scores on the primary sol for those students who are still learning recognizing that we do have students as you all know who are coming into our system who are not only not fluent in english but have been had interrupted formal education haven't been in school of any sort perhaps for years who have no literacy even in their aren't aren't

[05:00:54] literate in their home language etc etc that a year and a half is is is a very short window so And that's the basis for why we made that decision previously. I can say with pretty certainty that the U.S. Department of Education would not approve that.

[05:01:10] Virginia actually asked for that in 2006 and was denied from the U.S. Department of Education, I think, has asked since. But they did approve our current ESSA plan, so they do have some flexibility. But the current ESSA plan, I'll just sort of clarify what is allowable under federal law.

[05:01:27] So recent English learners, recently arrived English learners, do not need to be assessed on the reading assessment in their first year in the country. That is fine. They don't need to take the assessment, and they don't need to be included. But in their second year in the country, they do need to take the reading assessment and the math assessment and be included on those content assessments.

[05:01:48] They also are taking the WIDA test at the same time, and those WIDA results don't need be included in year one they do need to be included in year two so the us department of education has been very clear that both the content assessments the reading and maths and the elp assessments the weta assessments need to be included for english learners there is some flexibility a little bit and that is there is an option that states can choose in that second year instead of looking at proficiency, students could be included on a growth measure. Virginia did not

[05:02:28] use growth, so the VVAS measure in this case, growth in reading, and then in year three are included on growth and proficiency, but they cannot be excluded in year two on some sort of reading assessment. And that particular piece, that choice of in that second year in the country, do we just look at growth or do we look at proficiency is something that's in the ESSA plan.

[05:02:51] But what you're proposing, I think, which is to just look at the WIDA results would not be approved. Would not be approved for an ESSA plan, but we could have, as we do now, a state framework. Then we would have. Divergence, and then we would have two systems, which we are going to have anyway because of other decisions we're making.

[05:03:11] I mean, we're not making a lot. We're trying as hard as we can to adhere to it, but no. I think that the plan proposed regulation is only one system of support. Well, I won't argue on characterizing it, but I would argue that that would be a decision we could make to deviate the state system from the federal system.

[05:03:30] But if not, then I would encourage us to consider going as far as the ESSA would allow us, the feds would allow us to go, as you say, using the VVAS instead of the SOL for years two and three.

[05:03:50] We have so many English language learners, and they are not ready to take their SOLs. Many of them are not ready to take their SOLs in English in their second year in the country. So I will, Mr. Rotherham, did you have a comment? I was going to say, one of the reasons why, I mean, that's one of the reasons why states have chosen that growth approach.

[05:04:11] I will say some states choose to not use that approach. However, because it does require a recently arrived English learner to take the reading assessment in their first year so that growth can be measured in the second year. So there are trade-offs to consider there about, you know, if you are saying that year one, we don't want the English learners to have to take the reading assessment. It may be then preferable for the board's perspective to continue with the option Virginia is currently using, which is to have these English learners not take the assessments in year one, but in year two, they're included

[05:04:48] for proficiency or achievement mr rotherham yeah so what under the federal law under esso right now and then there's been obviously lots of you know applications and things that the that the department has signed off on and not signed off on like what is the maximum flexibility that we would have if we wanted to do that like even under that what it what is what is like what is the most robust thing we could even propose i think that the maximum flexibility is the one and a half years

[05:05:24] essa is categorically clear that recently arrived english runners must be included in their second year in the country and it is just that choice about do we include them on the growth metric which then might require them to be assessed a year earlier or do we include them on the proficiency metric in that second year and okay so okay so with that and i mean it's obviously it's a trade-off like in assessing kids on the growth assessment when they might be really recent arrivals that's there's one trade-off there the other trade-off is not every kid is going to be after a year and a half however a lot of them will and we do you know and as miss holton indicated

[05:06:04] many you know many are many or not it's a mick we should be very cautious talking about these kids in any sort of like homogenous way it's a it's a diverse group so the trade-off there is some kids we taking it they might not be doing well we'd be starting to get evidence and data about how they're doing and we'd be including them in the accountability system exactly i mean i think that's a good transition to this slide so can i just oh yeah why we would want to exclude rather than include kids as much as possible in the system that's what i'm struggling yes so my so

[05:06:39] i'll just say this um i taught a very complex subject to english language learners i taught civics so you have all of this this vocabulary that does not easily translate right but i think what we're not focused on here as much is we're we're talking about how we how we move kids from where they how they come to us to where they need to be and so that is going to be tough for the adults in the room and so that's where i am is we've got to do the hard things to make sure our

[05:07:14] kids i mean there is nothing harder to see than when english language learners are in a classroom with their peers who are speaking english and not only can they not speak the language they are not able to compete with them academically because of that we have got to do everything we can to get them to that place where they can do that as quickly as possible so that they're not experiencing other pieces of how tough life is in you know as we drag this out we have got to do the hard work

[05:07:53] to get it done in a year and a half yes they're going to be kids that can't because of all kinds of things we see even in our students who are native english speakers there are always those outliers. But for the majority of students, they have got to have this English language learners need the same opportunities as any other students in our school. And we have to get them to the place where they can do that. Yeah. And I think that's what this slide speaks to is that this system is about providing support. And right now, because Virginia is not even looking at English

[05:08:30] learners who are struggling for five years, schools that are having, you know, trying to do the hard work, but maybe need additional tools or resources, they're not being identified for those tools and resources. So, and we also know if you look at the research, it does, depending on where a student is coming from, the time for English learners to attain proficiency varies. It could be as short as two or three years, it could be six or seven years, it might just depend on that student's circumstances. But we do know that there is sort of a critical window of time to help these students. And that if a student becomes what's called a long-term English learner, they are most

[05:09:08] likely to never attain English language proficiency, more likely to drop out of high school, more likely to, you know, not have the post-secondary outcome. So it's really important to get to these students and to these schools that are doing the work as soon as possible. And by measuring them and including them, we're able to see which schools need support. You know, so the VDOE team and the Title III team,

which is the federal program to support English learners, can go in and work with those schools during that time.

[05:09:40] And it's also rewarding schools that do the hard work. You know, right now we're sort of just ignoring the problem as opposed to trying to really provide the supports they need. So we're talking about two different things here, right?

[05:09:57] WIDA is assessing where the child is relative to learning the English language. And an SOL test is assessing their content knowledge of reading and math. And the debate around ELL is that sometimes we don't know whether we're testing their ability of language acquisition on a state test or we're testing their content knowledge of what we're testing.

[05:10:19] So that's why it's so important to have the right modifications. Once we do the WIDA, if a child doesn't know English, then the accommodation is to give them a bilingual dictionary, give them a translated version of the test. the, I think if anything, we need to make sure that the supports and modifications for taking that test are aligned to the supports that the WIDA is saying that child is operating under, right? Because we know there are different levels of English proficiency. We don't, nobody in this room wants to, you know, get conflated between measuring their language acquisition and their

[05:10:55] content knowledge. So we just have to make sure whether we need to put that language somewhere, I don't know. But that's how you get around this, is you actually provide them what they need to understand and get over the hurdles of the language acquisition, whether that be a bilingual dictionary or a different, you know, translated version of the test and so on and so forth.

[05:11:14] Yeah, testing accommodations are critical. Yes. Any other questions on this? All right. I think it's maybe back to Chad now. Okay. We just wanted to provide that context. They, English learners are included in the models that I'm going to present as the way that Anne described it.

[05:11:41] What I'm going to show you are now our results. So please stop me if you have questions about any other how things were included or how they were built. What I'm going to show you is the results. They're going to show the distribution of schools, starting with elementary schools, based on mastery and growth.

[05:11:59] And they're going to be divided into four quadrants. So the bottom left will be schools that have lower growth and lower mastery scores. And the top right, the other extreme, will be higher growth and higher mastery scores. Each dot will represent one school, and they're also color coding based on the percentage of students in that school that are eligible for free and reduced-bias lunch, which is a measure of economic disadvantage. All right, so this is the elementary school results. Again, the

[05:12:34] quadrants are divided based on the median results across all schools. This is elementary schools. the orange schools, each dot, each orange dot is one school that has a higher percentage of free and reduced price lunch. So think of like low income schools are the orange schools.

[05:12:53] The blue dots are the other extreme. They're the ones that have fewer students that are eligible for free and reduced price lunch. And those are the blue dots. The gray dots are in between. So they are somewhere in between those two extremes. And there's a couple of things to note here.

[05:13:09] One is there are types of schools based on poverty in all the four different quadrants. So it's not necessarily that one type of school is necessarily in one other quadrant. There is some relationship

between achievement and growth, mastery and growth, but it's not a huge one.

[05:13:28] I think that's an important takeaway for from the data. The other thing to note is that, as we would have expected, schools with fewer disadvantaged students tend to score higher. So they have their higher above, but it's not universal either.

[05:13:43] It's a little more of a scattershot approach, if you will. The the way to look at the graph is from left to right is the mastery index. That's out of 65 because of the way the points work. Some schools actually can get more than 65 because of the advanced weighting that we have on the left is the growth weighting.

[05:14:04] So this is from 0 to 25. so higher growth scores means higher students more percent more students meeting their growth targets that year any yeah questions on this so if i'm understanding i'm trying hard looking at the graph here on my laptop and up here but i see no blue dots so no wealthier schools in the bottom left quadrant maybe there's one in there hiding somewhere but very few and very few in the upper left quadrant as well so basically all the wealthier schools are doing

[05:14:44] are above the median on the mastery index all or virtually off is that am i right on that there are some in every quadrants i think there's some poking out i would say your general characterization is correct that the wealthier schools tend to have higher performance and higher growth right and the poorer schools the orange dots the high free reduced lunch schools are uh there are certainly some in every quadrant but significantly to the left of the wealthier schools so lower

[05:15:17] performance on on um mostly below the median on the mastery index but a significant number of free reduced lunch schools uh doing better than the median on the growth index is that accurate That's, yeah, I think to Ms. Heislapp's point, this is a support system.

[05:15:37] So how do we identify schools that need support? And the schools that are towards the bottom left side are the schools that are not doing well overall and they're not helping students grow very much. And so that those are the schools we would want to identify. I also want the last point is that we looked at overlap between schools that are identified under this system as well as schools that are currently identified.

[05:16:01] And there's very similar overlap for those as well. So then just coming over to the right category, the right category is the beginning of what our ratings might look like for these schools. And they do show that with weighting mastery as heavily as we are weighting mastery, our rating system is going to show that wealthier schools do better and poor schools do worse.

[05:16:25] And I hear your point is that that's what we want it to show if we want to get support to those schools. And so leaving aside the support question for now, I just want us to be clear that our rating system is in significant part rating based on school's finances, the school's family's finances.

[05:16:45] And am I right that if we changed the allocation of growth and mastery, which we haven't made any final decisions on yet, we would end up with a system much less tied to poverty.

[05:17:04] And I do remind my fellow board members that the public told us loud and clear that we should weight growth at least equally with mastery. Our 585 task force told us that.

[05:17:23] The research tells us that. And frankly, all the other state school report cards that I've looked at, Tennessee, Florida, Ohio is one we've looked at. In all of those systems, growth is weighted at least as

high as mastery.

[05:17:42] So all that is by way of comment. But my question is, if we were to reallocate, which you all could easily do that, Ron, I'm sure, once you've got this data in, if we were to reallocate growth to be equal to mastery, then our rating system would not be so closely aligned with poverty. Is that right?

[05:18:11] Well, a couple of things. So the board did vote on the board did vote on an allocation of mastery and growth. So we use the board's choice on that front. To your other points, this this is one, it's pretty consistent with what Virginia is currently identifying. So it's not like it's more concentrated on poverty than what's currently happening.

[05:18:36] And I think it's about support. So if those schools are not doing well and their students are not growing, then those are the schools that we would want to identify and provide additional supports. I don't know if the board wants to react to any other comments as well. Mr. Sturckin.

[05:18:54] Yes, Madam President. Listening to Ms. Holton, I don't know whether or not she wants us to show something on a scale that looks better for growth than mastery. I think that's what I got.

[05:19:10] I think she was concerned that if it shows that poor schools, we need to show a way that poor schools look better on the chart than the reality of when schools don't have adequate resources, they're naturally not going to do as well, I think.

[05:19:33] So mastery is important. The most important, in my opinion. I don't think that for a scale, we should work it, show it so it looks good. I think we have to be honest. I think the goal should be for all of our children to master certain things versus a scale showing that they're doing good, but not mastering them. I think everyone knows that if you are in an area that you have tools, you have classrooms that are better, you have assets, you're going to succeed.

[05:20:12] um that's why certain people go to certain universities because of the the resources that are there um i believe in being honest if we value mastery which i think you would support our kids should master these things not just show a growth that they're working towards it um let the scale show what the scale is going to show um because we should challenge all of our kids to be in the mastery category versus growth. That's my thoughts. Dr. Siebert. So, Chad, I also was part of the

[05:20:47] conversation a couple months ago about the weighting piece. But regardless, no matter how we weighted growth right here on this chart, it's going to change it for every school. Therefore, the median will adjust. And so the distribution is going to continue to look about the same.

[05:21:04] And so so the the issue here is the harsh reality that, you know, this is the distribution. And and I definitely I certainly can see it.

[05:21:19] The the mastery piece that we have schools that are students are not measuring form. But I also regardless of where we said the growth piece, I like looking at the growth piece that there are places that are not growing. And so there are better resource places that children are not making the progress they should be making. But then the big part is wherever we set growth versus proficiency or whatever we call mastery, that lower left quartile is the heartbreaking part because these child are not growing at a rate to ever get them to the right. And so that's, again, but even if we

[05:21:58] changed the the weightings that would adjust for every school therefore the medians would adjust automatically and we still have a similar distribution correct yeah the distribution would not change

if that yeah that's right miss holton so uh mr sturdivant is of course right that mastery is the ultimate goal for all of our students and the good news is i think we all very much agree on that the question is how do we get there and i submit that the evidence shows that

[05:22:31] rating systems that weight growth that recognize schools that have succeeded in helping students grow towards mastery are are the most likely to help all students succeed that would be my first point my second point would be is absolutely the whole system is premised on the notion that we're going to send real supports to the schools that are struggling and i submit that this system we are adopting does not include any new money for any schools, so there are no new resources really.

[05:23:10] What we're talking about is reallocating the federal resources, perhaps a little bit more concentratedly depending on some of the decisions we make to the neediest schools, but those federal resources are a very small piece relative to the need. The evidence shows that currently our neediest schools receive no more than, and in some cases actually less than, the average per pupil allocations as our wealthier schools. And so to premise this system on the notion that

[05:23:46] these high-need schools are actually going to get any new support is a mistaken premise. And then And my final point would be just to recognize, essentially, if what we do is label schools without new supports, we are essentially labeling our schools, they're struggling mightily, and some of them making real progress, but not necessarily making the cuts.

[05:24:16] We're labeling them in such a way that will have a punitive consequence, will cause families and teachers to flee those schools. Those schools are already, as we've seen some recent reporting in the Richmond paper, already are most segregated schools by race as well as poverty, and it will only increase the pressures towards racial and economic segregation of those neediest schools.

[05:24:42] If we're labeling them and not supporting them, which is where this system is heading. So I'm going to start with the entire purpose for this new system was premised on support and how we are to get to that support.

[05:25:00] I recently sat with two different school division superintendents and much of their support staff from their central offices who told me from two different school divisions, both that have a number of high poverty schools in their districts and they said we are stuck with our hands tied in many circumstances with the money that is sent to us because we can only use it for certain things we've got this issue over here that we don't have money for because this money over here is just sitting there and so the entire purpose of this system is to be transparent

[05:25:37] about what these schools need. And then we are able to direct, we can go to the General Assembly and say, we know that these schools need this support specifically. Right now, our data points are so vague that simply throwing money at the problem is clearly not fixing it. And we're seeing that right here. Dr. Koons? I would add that we are actually putting, if we blend the federal and state system, we can actually spend the federal dollars. We have spent, we have sent an average

[05:26:11] of $10 million over the past five years in federal dollars back because of the constraints that President Creasy talked about. That's $49 million that we haven't spent in our current budget of federal dollars for our students and schools that need support because we can't direct the funds to the schools in a way in which they use them because our federal system and our state system is not aligned mr rotherham

um i think it's bad i have a quick just two clarifying questions then then a couple of comments um this is a census of all of our elementary schools correct correct okay

[05:26:50] um that's why i just want to make sure and so and then second if the the range that's 75 to 25 like that's there's a fairly like big difference between schools in that range does this look any different i mean i heard you say this basically aligns with what we have in in current day the current system all that i'm just curious does this look any different if we take any like finer grained cuts at it in terms of because i just have trouble like a school with like 28 poverty in school with you know 70 or 67 those are those are kind of different situations from an educational

[05:27:24] standpoint does it look any different sorry let me rephrase your question so are there uh ask my question a smarter way than i think uh so you're asking whether i'm just i'm struggling with that gray range because it just seems like a lot of schools are going to be in that and i'm not sure like schools above 75 i think are have a bunch of things in common schools uh under 25 that that middle range group just seems like a very very diverse group of schools right so that's actually the middle group of schools is not poverty level. So it's not 25% free and beer spice lunch and 75%

[05:28:02] free and beer spice lunch. It's essentially ordering all schools and which ones are the top 25 and which ones are the bottom 25. So the middle is the middle 50 essentially is the better way to think of it. Okay. Okay. But you don't think if we took any finding, this is basically the pattern? Yeah. I mean, this is the way it is. And then the colors are just to give you a sense of where they fall in that uh economic distribution then yeah then i mean i guess then i just i agree with my colleagues especially uh dr seabroo has fantastic taste in in in clothing i must uh i must

[05:28:35] i must mention um i'd be i'd be remiss i'd be remiss not to not to note um uh that we look we have a choice here the the the bottom uh the bottom quartile on our on our lower left that is i think you used the word heartbreaking and that is and we have we have a choice here we can try to make that quartile look better or we can own up that that is a huge problem for this commonwealth and we need to address it i speaking as just one board member i think spending is a piece of that i don't know how we get there if we don't just start to get really honest about where

[05:29:08] we are and and lean into that and hope that then there is a sustained effort beyond just this board this administration to really lean into that and address that but trying to just make that problem look like it's not so much for a problem i don't know i don't know who we're helping and pick on this model of like making sure every kid counts i think the only way we do that is by being honest about where every kid is and you know everything on the on the right side of that bar is an issue and i think you could argue it the other way and be like we don't you know we you can look at this data and i think everything to the on the mastery um uh the lower end of mastery whether it's high

[05:29:46] growth or low growth you could argue that either way and i'm not sure where that gets us i think we just need to figure out how we move that and i would note that some states and we heard you know over the years now with with people coming in like florida and so forth that had a really hard edge on their accountability system and and didn't worry about that actually saw tremendous gains uh on the nape uh and so i i i don't have a problem with that with that we just need to recognize what we're signing up for which is a sustained concerted effort to address this problem just to be clear florida rates growth equal to mastery or higher it may be that they rate it

[05:30:25] equal and then they also have a gap closing measure that's essentially a growth measure right my point though is in the in terms like their lowest performing schools they label they offer choice they basically do everything that is sort of conventional wisdom you're not supposed to do they did and saw the best gains in the country for a while particularly for our other conversation for hispanic youngsters um and so i don't have i mean i don't think we're overweighting on on sort of being harsh or anything like that i think we're we're coming down in a good place on just leveling with people on where we are and hopefully having a discussion in this commonwealth about what that means and how do we move those schools and those kids that

[05:31:02] are in that uh low lower quartile there how do we move them to where we all want them to be dr siebert and this is really just for a later point when you get to it will help me because we've already kind of established that wherever we set the things there's going to be medians there's going to be quartiles obviously our goal is going to be able to we can count on the higher growth places moving toward mastery and we got to worry about the lower growth places whether they're already mastery or not so with your low growth low mastery that's absolutely got to be the issue

[05:31:37] regardless of where the median lines fall. So that low of the quartile is where the work's going to be. My question will be later, based on these numbers, because you're looking at the two factors, is when we get to the descriptors, you know, where do the descriptors match up with these quadrants? Because, you know, there's, there's, you can be on track and growing, or, or, so that's where I'm going to, I'm going to need some help with that when we get there. So hopefully that's coming as an important. Ms. Holden. So we're talking about, you know, the lowest quartile is

[05:32:15] where we want to focus. But am I right, Chad, that if we wanted the lower quartile to be our primary focus, then we would want to be weighting growth and mastery equally, because that's what the lower quartile is, the lower half of each of those categories. So frankly, with us weighting mastery more heavily, essentially what we're doing is taking a good number of the schools that are above the median for growth, but below the median for mastery and shoving them down into the lower

[05:32:52] quarter, lower left quarter. We haven't gotten into discussion about the categorization, which I'm going to talk a little bit about. Essentially, if you think about where they fall into an overall thing you could I'm just going to point here you can think about a portal like this because it is a combination so the what's called the bottom five percent of schools are probably somewhere down there and then from there if you're thinking about the difference performance categories that we had earlier it'd be like where do we set those thresholds and this is only looking at two

[05:33:29] variables so the mastery and uh growth there are readiness categories as well but that's sort of one way to think about it is where we set those lines, if you will. And we've already sort of set the board has set the through the regulation.

[05:33:45] It has set those weights. And so if a future board were to change those weights, it would be like changing the sort of directionality rather than being like this. Just to be clear, we have not decided anything yet by way of final decision because the regs are just proposed regs and they're out for coming.

[05:34:08] so it's all tentative decisions today the board voted on those regulations they're out for public comment so that that's what i was referring to him but essentially these schools are low we're talking about schools that are low status and low growth right right okay and i think we have to be there there's there's this idea that most of the schools that are low status are actually high growth and we're and we're not being

fair to them and so forth we have a lot of low status low growth schools that hardly makes us unusual every state has those for the most part um it just depends on sort of numbers and distribution distribution so we're not unusual like that but that's the reality

[05:34:48] those schools exist i worry we fall into this idea that if we focus on mastery proficiency status sort of all these high growth schools are sort of going to be unfairly labeled but we're looking at data that is showing we have we do have some low status high growth schools for sure you can see them but we also have a lot of low growth low status schools and that's a crisis but dr northern so chad you may know more about florida system than i do but i do know that one of the subgroups they track and that we could consider is the lowest 20 lowest performing 25 right like they

[05:35:27] call out that subgroup just like they call out ells or students with disabilities and that actually helps them to focus resources and supports to that particular subgroup so it's a little bit a different way to get around some of the things that we're talking with here i mean i just pulled up i mean it's been it was very successful it's been studied i've got the data point here it led florida's focus on the lowest performing 25 of students led to significant performance increases among traditionally underperforming summer groups it went on and on made the biggest gains in nape and fourth grade reading so on and so forth keep in mind

[05:36:02] florida had an a through f system okay so it's very hard as researchers to disentangle was it the a through f or was it this performance on the 25 lowest percent or was it both but i do think that i don't know what you know about you know how that particular emphasis worked in in florida that has been shown to be um quite positive at least relative to all the studies i've seen miss fulton i i i was just looking at the florida system yesterday and if i remember it correctly it weights growth and mastery equally and then has an extra measure absolutely dr northern

[05:36:40] for uh the lowest 25 performance and that measure is a growth measure not a mastery measure so it is focusing on helping identify the schools that are uh succeeding or not in helping the neediest students grow but that would be an argument for more growth weight not for more mastery weight and and just to be clear here if we continue to an elementary school weight mastery more than double what we weight growth then we are taking some of the schools in the upper left-hand

[05:37:18] quadrant who are succeeding in helping students grow significantly and still weighting them poorly on our summative rating because they aren't doing well enough yet on mastery so essentially the lines our system wouldn't be a square uh perpendicular dividing line it would be tilted up because of the heavier weighting of of of mastery much heavier weighting i don't want to get too

[05:37:57] much in the weeds but we don't know exactly how our growth system is measuring growth um you know it's a psychometrician spend a lot of time on this and our provider does these systems across the country we should probably at some point get a layman's description of that but my understanding is that the growth is a pretty vigorous definition by sas and the growth that we've had in this state has has has honestly not been so because we haven't had the measures in place to do it properly yet. So I feel like there's an overture of this conversation that somehow

[05:38:33] growth is going to be less aggressive, less whatever, when the fact of the matter is that the SOL test frankly compared to other tests is not as rigorous as many other state tests. So I think we're looking at a whole new, like we might as well throw out the old playbook because we got a brand new one, right? Because I think when we talk about, you know what we want to do in terms of improving our our test and

what we want to do in terms of improving what a real growth system looks like i'm just not even sure that some of the assumptions we're making about growth are our whole are going to hold true yeah i'd agree with dr north i just

[05:39:10] want to add like i i want to we have to bud spilling the long time to return for a bit to say the young you know make sure the main thing is the main thing the main thing here like we can argue about this all day we live in a state where 60 of our black kids are not at nate basic in eighth grade 50 of our hispanic kids are not there half of our low-income kids our free introduced price launch kids are not there slightly more than that we can go around and around on this all day and we can argue all these different things or we can say in any other context we'd be saying that is a crisis that is an absolute crisis and why is there not lots of attention on it why aren't we talking about it honestly why isn't the governor out every day

[05:39:50] talking about why is this front page in the media and instead we just spin and spin on where are we going to where are we going to draw these lines those kids don't get to those outcomes and i would remind you the commissioner of education statistics stood before us and said people can argue about nape advanced you can argue about nape proficient everybody agrees below basic means you are functionally unprepared for opportunity and which means we have failed collectively at our at our responsibility you're unprepared for opportunity um we just have to get serious about that those kids they're not just springing up they're not just coming here from elsewhere and so forth that is a phenomenon that is happening in our commonwealth and it is the result of what we see here is how

[05:40:30] those kids end up and we either bite the bullet and get serious about that or we continue to try to figure out like what kind of story do we want to tell and so forth i would submit we we're at the edge of the cliff we're looking over traditionally you know and that's not a virginia thing that's a national thing we we see it in dr hansen as those scars as well we look over we look over the cliff and we back up but this is one of these times we need to look over the cliff hold hands and call attention to this and hope that we get that kind of that that level of urgency with this sort of slow motion crisis that unfolds it's not exciting it's not it's not big news like when a plane crash or something it's just slow motion unfolds every day and the only way we're

[05:41:08] going to call attention to it is by being honest straightforward and as transparent as we can about what is going on the i'm going to take that opportunity to say a couple things one is that as far as i know this is some of the first looks comparing school level growth data versus proficiency versus poverty rates in virginia so this is a big deal for the city to have this data and it can be changed over time to miss holton's point if the waiting the future board wants to change the waiting and play around with it they can model it going forward to miss northern's point, if they want to focus on growth for other groups, we can do that. But this is the first

[05:41:46] attempt to look at it. So I did want to take us to the middle school. It looks very similar in terms of the graph, the setup, the results look slightly different. There's a couple of things to note. One is the overall weighting is different. So the mastery index is only out of 60. The growth is out of 20 to create room for more of the readiness measures. And otherwise, the distribution is fairly similar. There's, again, schools of all different types in all the different quadrants as well. And then if there's questions about this, I'm happy to, or I was going to talk about some

[05:42:22] of the distribution questions and the identity. We did some modeling and looking at identification if you're open or ready to hear some of those discussion. I'll start and please interrupt me.

[05:42:41] The first in the federal regulation and in the proposed regulation, there will be a category of schools that are called Comprehensive Support and Improvement, and those will be the bottom 5% of Title I schools. So Title I schools are a subset of all schools statewide.

[05:42:57] So it works out to about 3% of all schools, 2% to 3% of all schools in the state will be identified for that category. Then what we also did is there's another category of schools called TSI, targeted support and intervention. And what we did for there is say those are schools that have any individual student group that is performing at the same level or below as the comprehensive support schools.

[05:43:24] So essentially, we use the CSI, comprehensive support, to set a cut point or a threshold. And then we look to see which schools have student groups that are below that threshold. And we, as I mentioned earlier, we ran two models. Model 1 had fewer schools in it.

[05:43:40] It was looking only at schools with a very normal grade configuration. Model 2 had more schools in it, including some of the different grade configurations. Model 2 also had a lower weight for English learners and had a lower weight for a win to look for a student group, number of students in that minimum.

[05:44:00] But the range is the thing I would focus on. So the range of schools that were identified for a target support was between 9% to 25% of all schools statewide. So that gives us some parameters to start thinking about what are different levers we might want to pull to adjust those going forward, whether that's the right amount or whether that's too high or too low.

[05:44:22] And then the other category, which we're not going to talk about today, is what's called additional targeted support and improvement. Those are schools that have a low-performing student group that stays low-performing over time. So the TSI, the targeted support, are identified annually. The additional targeted support are identified because those schools don't improve for those subgroups.

[05:44:42] And we can't model that yet with just one year of data. I will pause there. Any questions on this high-level identification question? Ms. Holden. So, Chad, I see you say down below both models identified a reasonable number of schools for support from the Office of School Quality.

[05:45:02] I'd just like to understand that a little better. By my calculations, Model 1 produces somewhere around 200, a little over 200 schools identified for either comprehensive or targeted school support, whereas Model 2 identifies almost 500 schools.

[05:45:25] I'm just doing 2% plus 25% of our 1,800 schools. Have you all calculated the resources of the Office of School Quality and their capacity to support either 200, I'm coming up with 216 under Model 1 or 486 under Model 2, it's 277 more schools.

[05:45:51] Is OSQ up to the job under their current staffing for either of those? Well, I can't answer that question. What I can't answer is it's tough to compare exactly to what's currently happening in Virginia, because Virginia has two systems for identification. There's the state system, as well as the federal system.

[05:46:11] And both of these models identified similar numbers as the cumulative numbers that are being identified already statewide. Just for some perspective, the currently identified schools, there are about 10% of schools that are TSI schools.

[05:46:27] So about 10% of schools are currently identified for what's called targeted support and improvement. But Virginia, I think, as you pointed out in other rounds of conversation, is Virginia has

other ways through the state support system to flag schools that need to do other sort of academic reviews and things.

[05:46:44] So that's where the word reasonable comes from, is trying to put that in perspective. But the current Virginia system, if I remember correctly, you're right, we identify schools under both the federal system and our state system, but they largely overlap. And together, I think I remember that it's something like 250 schools that are identified.

[05:47:05] That department would, I'm sure, know that number and could give it to us. But to me, it looks like Model 1 would probably be consistent with that and Model 2 would be double that. and what the choices are that get us from Model 1 to Model 2, I don't know or understand and would love to understand more.

[05:47:23] Dr. Koons, would you like to speak to that? Yeah, so we already identify 5% for Model 1 and Model 2 for CSI. That is no change at all. I just spoke to this. I'm going to say it again. These are federally identified. Right now, because we run two parallel systems, we are sending about $10 million back for the past five years of federal dollars to support these schools.

[05:47:45] that's 50 mil almost 50 million dollars over the past five years we have not accurately or well used the dollars we have because we have not had the opportunity to use them effectively so to predict whether or not we need more money or have not had more money we have not had a coherent system to drive supports because our federal dollars we have consistently sent back so i want to push on the fact that quantifying the number of schools doing that saying this is more than that is regardless because we haven't had one coherent and cohesive system to provide support and when we

[05:48:23] have talked out in the public and gotten public feedback we have repeatedly heard about frustrations of having two systems and how to spend the money as Chad indicated sometimes I have money for this sometimes I have money for that how do I send that money we are sending a lot of that back because we are not focusing on the students who need support regardless of whether or not they need support. And Mr. Rotherham said it's time for us to be honest and support. So we have got to be able to have a system that allows us to drive the federal and the state dollars and the funds we have to support our students, which we have not done well over the past five years. And it is about

[05:48:58] 50% of our budget that we have been sending back because of the separation between federal and state systems. I think you mean 50% of the OSQ, of that federal support budget, which is a very, very small percentage of our overall 18 billion dollar school system I mean it's you know one 20th of one percent or something so it's not a large portion of our support budget right because our support budget is from the state basically zero so our only federal support is the federal

[05:49:30] money. The big picture problem here is that our OSQ is already woefully inadequate, as JLARC has told us. And aligning the state and federal system completely makes sense, but they're already targeting virtually the same schools. So it's not going, and I hear you, it's going to help on the bureaucracy and the paperwork, and it's going to direct more money to real results rather than bureaucracy and paperwork, and that's a good thing, but it's very much incremental. The big

[05:50:07] picture is we're not sending any real new money to our neediest schools, to our schools that are most struggling, and we're not funding the Office of School Quality. So we need to fund the oversight system better, and we need to send, as many other states do, actual resources to the schools that going to

be the df schools or whatever we decide to call df schools to change make the label softer but we we are not really sending any new money to them and until we do that we're not going to

[05:50:42] see the kinds of results you've talked about in other states mr rotherham so just two quick comments one we can argue about how much sending back was it 40 million dollars 49 million dollars is i would note that is high leverage money because we can actually use it for it's less restricted than other money somebody mentioned earlier you know school principals talk about how the money comes down that's money we can actually use so it's it's it's higher leverage dollars and again we've had this discussion i think like most people hear 49 million dollars i hear 49 million dollars and i'm like that's a lot of money um and i think and we and and we should not be sending

[05:51:18] 49 million dollars of our education money that's allocated to virginia to help these schools under no circumstances we'd be sending that back to washington that's insane um and so we need we need to fix that um i think we have we're back to it this is a conversation we've been having on this board for quite a while now it's a basic chicken and egg system i don't disagree we need to spend more money on uh school improvement we should do more there the question is does that happen just by i don't know osmosis or it just sort of comes into being because we keep doing the same things or does it happen because we say in our role as a policy making board we're not the appropriators

[05:51:55] We're not these other roles. We say, here's the problem. Here's what's going on. Let's focus on this. And as I said a minute ago, hopefully that then drives people will start asking questions of why isn't this a bigger focus of attention constantly. And it is, I say, chicken and egg, just because some people are going to argue we'll know that first we had to do all this other stuff, then we can have an accountability system.

[05:52:18] I think that's backwards. I think the experience of other states shows that's backwards. And what we need here, and we've been hearing that, including from Dr. Coons, shows that that's backwards. We've got to put in place a system that honestly says what's going on, and then we can expect things to start to go. And hopefully people will see that, whether it's in the General Assembly, it's citizens, it's education leaders in the state will see that and respond. We've tried the other way for a long time, and here's where we are. We ought to try a different way of just being really straightforward about what's going on and then hoping, and I do trust in the leadership of this commonwealth, that we will see the response commensurate to the nature of the

[05:52:58] problem. Okay, go ahead, Chad. Yeah, I have a couple things I wanted to clarify and note. So one is under this, this would be the federal system. It's hard to compare to what Virginia currently has because virginia currently has a state identification system and a federal identification system but under the current federal system the state is identifying about don't quote me but 140 150 uh target support schools that works out to very similar numbers to what we're seeing here and that's sort of what i'm trying to convey to you all is that we're not crazy out of the ballpark here we're at least in the right target we're not releasing any of

[05:53:37] those schools where this is purely modeling is purely for informational sake and it starts this conversation of how much can we target we started this at the last conversation of do we want to go a lot of money into very few schools or do we want to spread it a little bit thinner and the other things to think about is how we want to set those cut points so one really quirky thing that surprised me when i was

working looking at the numbers is model 2 had a lower weight for english learner progress. English learner progress, the rates are much lower than the other indicators.

[05:54:11] And so I thought, well, if we include it at a lower weight, it will pick up fewer schools. But that's not what happened. It actually did the other thing because essentially that raised the cut point. Every school got a little bit higher, which meant then when you looked at subgroups to see how they performed, it picked up more schools that fell under that cut point.

[05:54:30] And so that is a lever the board can potentially pull to manipulate whether it's the right number or how we think about identification purposes. Quickly, because we're moving on. So just, I do think it's an, I'm hearing you say that the choice between model one and model two is significant.

[05:54:52] I mean, it's 15% of our schools, whether they're identified for some kind of significant support. And I'm hearing you say that is, are we going to concentrate our resources on a smaller number of more needy schools?

[05:55:07] Are we going to spread them out more? So that's a pretty significant decision between Model 1 and Model 2. Are we, how are we, how and when are we making that choice? Is that one of the decision points that you need direction on today so that we can finalize it in July or what?

[05:55:28] I would defer to Superintendent Coons a little bit here, but I would say it would be helpful to hear the board's feedback on does 9% sound too low, does 25% sound too high, or is 25% still too low as well?

[05:55:45] if you have any impressions on that and maybe you don't want to talk in percentages if you'd rather prefer to talk about concentration of resources versus identification so uh there will still be the comprehensive support schools the money will still go to those schools but how much do we want to also uh have resources for schools that are struggling with a particular subgroup so those sort of uh nuance and discussion points i think it would be helpful for the board to to weigh in know if you have if you have thoughts if you feel that right moment though or do we have more

[05:56:22] modeling that is going to lead us to that particular discussion in the next few slides this is the extent of the full uh modeling so this would be the time if you would rather take some break time to digest it that would be uh something we could do as well potentially okay let's um

[05:56:39] let's do that let's take 10 minutes um we'll be back at three of six do you have a question

[06:09:06] yeah maybe if we go back to slide 21 and i'm not sure if i have my math correct on your modeling but um if we there on the english language progress of the 15 to 5 percent if we just ran it at 10 would that give us obviously between 9 and 25 percent that it would fall but it might be a rational approach to be looking at or would that might be helpful just to know what it is so we

[06:09:41] can pick up look at the data and they said that we do more of the windows uh we showed you this to

[06:10:16] so we can get you guys to run right proceed please sorry across the different performance bands

[06:11:35] and so the one on the right is the equal version and it gives the only difference between the left and the right is the waiting for below basic below basic goes from 0.25 to 0.5 so essentially students who are low performing get more credit on the right hand side both of these models we looked at they include

the same subjects as well as english language proficiency and the alternative assessment as well. And same as before, students or tests that only have three performance bands only use the three higher levels. The results, as we've shown you before, are very similar across

[06:12:14] the different indices. So there is a different range, particularly on the low end, because it gives more weight for below basic. The equal weight has a slightly higher floor. So if you see it goes from 12.4 up to 16.8 is the floor for the equal weighted version uh also we also looked at correlations just to see the differences across schools and they're very highly correlated uh 0.989 so the two models are very very similar it's more about emphasis and how we want to uh emphasize it

[06:12:54] from the state level the other thing i will say is that um to my earlier point about english learners any time we're raising the scores overall for schools that potentially puts the risk that we will identify more student groups for the target support category so that is just something to consider i can't say that i've modeled that particular math but it is something that would be potentially possible with if we went to the equal weighted proficiency band so any questions thoughts on this i don't believe we're taking an official vote it's more of uh the board's

[06:13:32] sense of how we're perceiving and going forward and what we'll keep using in in the future models

[06:13:52] yes so it's a quirk in the math that when you raise the floor for schools overall you're essentially raising the cut point for the comprehensive support schools. So if all schools, sorry, let me say this again. If the floor for the comprehensive support schools is currently 50 points in the index, and all of a sudden you bump it up to 60 points, that is the new index.

[06:14:20] You're still capturing the same 5% in the comprehensive support, but now 60 is the level you're looking for student groups performance as a comparison. And so you capture more targeted support schools because you have a higher cut point. And the cut point is tied to the overall 5% threshold. Ms. Holtan. So I'm still confused. Which of those two, how does these two, this choice between these two options relate to what you just described about comprehensive schools and

[06:14:59] what would be the criteria by which we should choose between the two options? Yeah, they relate because the equal weighted model gives more credit and gives more points. So it essentially raised the cut point, the comprehensive support cut point, that then we would look to identify low-performing schools, subgroups of students, and on a higher threshold. And because it's a higher threshold it would likely capture more schools as well that would fall under that

[06:15:32] range so the equal one would capture more schools for targeted support correct and that does not determine anything necessarily about our uh accountability categories it just determines the how many schools for targeted support that's right that's right dr sievert jack could you go back up two slides which is the same thing but it's in a chart form one more there you go so i just like this one's more side by side sure um so i think that's an interesting point you raise about what

[06:16:11] the floor does and so thank you for sharing that with us um and and i i just this is more of a thought out loud i'm interested what my colleagues think um you know going back to you know our conversations back in the fall about understanding the importance under the nape thresholds of what basic means you know in my notes from the our april retreat i wrote down the ones on the left and and dr

northern i called it amber's i don't know if i attributed it correctly or not but at that point in time what i a little bullet that i made then was that it almost incentivized moving

[06:16:48] people out of below basic to basic um what we've just heard is that it doesn't really impact you know a lot of things it's highly correlated etc and maybe it has an added advantage of not over identifying some other things but so i that the idea of incentivizing move from below basically basic uh was a note that i made at the time i don't know if i made the note that that was a good incentive or not so i'm just kind of curious if any other colleagues have better

[06:17:15] recollections of the april meeting than i do well because you get every child you move from below basic to basic that's a that's a that's considerable that's a bigger oh no on the proficiency model the left side that that counts more than it does on the right and and so that

[06:17:46] that's I think that's what I was thinking in April. Below basic is getting more weight in the system and less weight in the other system, right? So I don't see it as incentivizing. I see it as do you want to say a child who's below basic counts more or less in the system, you know, in terms of the weighting? I think I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I think I'm saying the one on the left

[06:18:18] incentivizes moving a child from below basic to basic is that so this was your argument when you brought this was that if we had below basic at 0.25 and basic at 0.75 you have more incentive oh move a child from below basic because you're going to get more weight at the basic level correct yeah sorry i wasn't tracking so what's the question i'm sure i was i was asking if that's

[06:18:54] what your point you're making in april and then i think i described it poorly uh but i think you fixed it for me uh no no yes i think you you guys fixed it for me that's what i said yes so the decision point here is you want us to give you guys feedback on whether or not we want to use proficiency or equal in the mastery index so we use the proficiency in models one and two and uh if the board would prefer us to move to the equal weight we could make that change

[06:19:31] going forward and i think this you know right we we had asked for more modeling so as we move forward and as you finalize the modeling i think you're asking which one is that right yeah okay sorry i was just asking i'm i agreed with um dr northern's incentivizing that moving kids from below basic to basic so that would keep me on that proficiency side i don't know what the

[06:20:06] rest of the board feels on the comments agree disagree want to see something different what madam president just i want to make sure we um make sure ms ashton knows we want to hear from her off in electronic land if and when she has more wisdom for us which i know she will

[06:20:47] i was just encouraging you to chime in and know that we know you're there and we'd love to hear from you on no i don't mean on this particularly but just on all of the above yes so many thoughts so i'll share a couple and i really do apologize for not being in person i um and i think i've said this before as a school leader i am going through this exact process right now for myself

[06:21:22] and my school and one thing that i think is incredibly important is just the transparency in terms of the how so what we're going through in terms of what's in the scores and the how and the planes and the weights i think is incredibly important for leaders district leaders to understand it is obviously very complicated but i think this transparency is really important i think too what's really hard is building the plane while you're flying it because you know we want to use real data to be able to protect to predict real stories and and

[06:21:58] be able to make real decisions but we're getting data you know as we go so it is helpful for me to see um the the plot the dot plots like that is really helping me to see the where schools land not surprising it's pretty pretty standard but for me i saw so many bright spots when i saw orange dots in the right top column which was high mastery high growth which is exactly for me what we want to be able to see which is there are some schools that are self-serving the most at

[06:22:36] risk um the most at promise students and who are having high mastery and high growth and so i think that to me is probably you know the most helpful tool because i want to know what are those schools doing what resources do they have now how do we make sure the schools that are you know the bottom ones are getting those resources so i think that is incredibly helpful um and then the last thing and i think this is where we're going is it's going to just take more time for schools and divisions to kind of process this but again i'll tell you what i'm doing with my accountability

[06:23:16] part is i am really looking at the scores right now and i am directing resources towards those priorities like chronic absenteeism versus in school attendance so i think that i think the transparency around the weight that i think you guys call it the math approach is exactly what schools need to understand where to prioritize the resources that they have where to you know identify the right spots across the state um and then you know the last part i will say is no one

[06:23:52] is surprised by the most researched schools having the highest proficiency and the highest growth i that's a surprise i would like to know what they're doing too and how do we transfer their best practices to to other schools across the state so i find this i find the update promising no it's you know i i have a sense that the group is like give us all the information now tell us exactly what it is so that we can make sense and make decisions i can say it's a messy process but i appreciate the transparency around creating a process and believe we will get there it uh it's

[06:24:32] just gonna just gonna take time with even more data so those are my general thoughts um thank you miss holton i am sitting here at the edge of my seat my dog at my feet um listening to everything you all are saying thank you thank you uh well hearing no objections on the mastery index we're going to keep proceeding with the proficiency index the mastery index and um we'll have that in model three um the next element to circle back on the group is about middle school

[06:25:08] readiness and the other components that are included in that bucket so just as a reminder growth is uh 20 for middle school mastery is 60 we're going to talk about the 20 bucket so chronic absenteeism we waited in this model at 10 to keep it consistent across grades and we're going to look at the advanced coursework um that's a cool feature all right um there's been a lot of

[06:25:41] feedback on this particular indicator one thing that we discussed at the last meeting was focusing in on the denominator making sure that it is limited to students who are ready to succeed in advanced coursework so we call it the florida denominator it's something that the florida system uses of limiting the denominator to students who show proficiency in seventh grade then looking to see whether in eighth grade they are taking and succeeding in an end of course assessment and we're agnostic on which particular end of course assessment they take we included uh different ones

[06:26:21] in that um so it does include algebra geometry and algebra 2. algebra is by far the most common that's taken but just so you know that we are agnostic to that it is a cohort model so we're we're looking at students take it by eighth grade, and it does use students who had a seventh grade test score to

see whether they're proficient to include in the denominator as well. We started by looking at math. So we looked at, this is just math, this is sort of the distribution of school

[06:26:56] level results. A couple things to note. One is that most schools have at least, almost all schools, Almost all middle schools have at least some students who are taking advanced math. So the pathway exists in most parts of the state.

[06:27:11] That doesn't mean that all students are taking it. And so this is of the, we use eligible, the people that are in the denominator that I mentioned. 61% of those students took and passed and were successful in an advanced math course.

[06:27:27] If you look at it by race, that's 63% of white students, 53% of black students, 52% of Hispanic students, 83% of Asian students, and 47% of low-income students. We also looked at it by geographies and different communities across the state. It's 66% in cities, 47% in rural communities.

[06:27:51] They have the pathway, like I mentioned, but maybe they aren't getting as many students into it. maybe they don't have the same amount of teachers or other things 69 in suburban schools and 43 in towns and as i mentioned before uh 96 of middle schools had at least one student who was passing an eoc math course in eighth grade we also looked at other subjects the board was interested in how to incentivize other subjects as well we limited to subjects that had an end of course assessment we the video we had a conversation with the u.s department of ed and u.s department of ed had

[06:28:29] concerns that the other ways to measure quality were not standardized and consistent across states so if we looked only at grades for example that wouldn't be a way to look and make sure that it was a consistent metric statewide so we use the eoc and look to see other subjects and math is by far the highest percentage or number of kids who are taking advanced math.

[06:28:55] It's 43,000 kids across the Commonwealth who are taking advanced math course by the end of eighth grade. For science, it's about 11,000. And for history or social science, it's about 7000. And we included any tests of an eighth grader, whether they were taking and passing an end of course assessment.

[06:29:17] The other thing is that it's not those pathways are not as common as the math pathways are so only 38 of middle schools had at least one student passing an eoc science course and 36 of middle schools had at least one student passing an eoc history course i think that is all of the data we have to share what we need from you all is feedback on which of these options you would like to pursue of would you like to include other subjects would you like

[06:29:51] to keep it simple as just math for now the sort of drawbacks with the other subjects are that it's not as accessible there aren't as many students or as many schools that have those pathways that have as many students going through them you could look at the other way and say well we would like to incentivize this as a state and the accountability system could be one way to encourage more schools to have those pathways and to be looking to see which of their students could be successful and potentially taking them so those are sort of the pros and cons of the different approaches we're here to get your feedback on uh those questions and and hear your thoughts i know

[06:30:26] we had discussed aside from just math but having some kind of humanities subject that we would include here and so i do think you know while we're giving that that tip to math i do think we need to include um a subject in the humanities um area as well i don't know how the rest of the board feels. Dr.

Northern? I guess I just want a definition of what an advanced course looks like in history and social science. So, I get it in math, you know, you're taking the next course in

[06:31:01] the sequence earlier than you typically would. What does it mean in science? So, you're, again, you're skipping ahead to the next course outside of your grade level, and how are advanced defined in science and history? Science, the vast majority of those are science, as what students are taking across the Commonwealth. And that's advanced because they're taking it earlier than they normally would? Yes. Yeah. And it's an end of course assessment. It gives them high school credit as well. So normally you take it in what grade and you're taking it in what grade instead?

[06:31:36] I'm just trying to really get this. Yes. But I mean, it does, it's tied to the credit that the students accumulate as well. I think when we originally discussed this, the loose parameters where advanced meant you got high school credit in middle schools in some way.

[06:31:54] I think when we loosely talked about this early on, it was, and we, in the slide, we asked for public feedback. We tried to align some of the EOC courses, but to a lot of your points, there isn't necessarily a match there in that space, which makes it hard for the data and the prediction of what could work there.

[06:32:18] Dr. Sievert. So I'm just going to think out loud here, which is dangerous in a session like this, but I share the president's idea that, you know, it'd be good to have more here. I just don't know if we're ready for more yet. And so I think this is an area that we're kind of emerging.

[06:32:39] We've not had this readiness indicator before. And so sometimes I think, you know, it's more important that we do something well than we do it big. so so so a couple of thoughts here um i i mean i'm a former science teacher and so i certainly don't want to devalue uh science or any humanities but you know there when you look across the commonwealth of virginia one of the few places do local divisions have local control are the pathways they do knit together for science and history and those kinds of things and so localities get to do things differently based on how many middle schools they have how many high schools they have what are the feeder patterns for their middle schools and high schools and so they do those

[06:33:17] things differently especially with social studies and science at the at the middle school at the with math however why you see so many more students taking math is there's also just more math courses because by the time you get to high school there's different all kinds of other you start algebra functions and data analysis there's more choices at the high school level so so there's different types of pathways within those content areas so to although i do think it would be nice as down the road to do more. I think the first beta step here, this readiness piece, might be to do the math piece where we're seeing there's already the most critical massive

[06:33:53] opportunity to try to do that part and do that part well and then to come along. Now I also then wonder, and I don't want to ask if it's possible because I actually think most everything is possible is this how is the juice worth the squeeze and and and maybe as we if the first step is to focus on math is there a way to throw in um you know some breadcrumbs or crackers or maybe not not not not something that's reported not not accountability piece not where it affects your your score or your label but maybe there's still a reporting piece for other advanced courses

[06:34:31] and again i get dr norton's concerned about what we call advanced but other high school credit bad forces so it wouldn't be part again we've talked in the past there'd be things that go into what gets you your label but there's also things that will be reported but not part of that system so maybe we start off with the readiness piece including the math at middle school but we also report what's happening with other math high school credit forces at the middle school level that would be a way to kind of again move that we want children being challenged and and getting high school credits but also leaving some local control in terms of what content areas they do it and also accepting the harsh realities that some of those high school credit courses and middle

[06:35:11] schools are very difficult to staff i think that's why you see the number smaller in the rural areas miss holton chad if we included science or history what would we use for the denominator so in other words in math there's an obvious did you pass the prior years assessment but we don't have but one science and history assessment in the middle school band i think so there's no denominator we looked at using uh pass or advanced in math or english as a way to english okay but

[06:35:50] not because there is english but there isn't science or history correct so i think that is a problem i i'm and also going back to the slide with the rural communities uh the prior slide that rural communities have a much lower level of of advanced and of course grades i do think that some of that speaks to um dr siebert was starting to mention that one of the issues here is staffing and i hear you saying that everybody has at least some option but i think there are

[06:36:25] certainly in our rural schools and some of our more challenged urban schools staffing those math algebra one classes in middle school is a real a real challenge and i i want to submit not that i i think this is an incredibly important priority is getting more students to pass algebra one in eighth grade and i completely understand why we're focusing on it but i wonder if the right approach would be to use this as a reporting criteria for the first year and not kick it in

[06:37:03] to an accountability criteria until at least year two because frankly any decisions that were if if accountability is meant to help schools rise to the uh occasion on the incentive on the items we're incentivizing them on this system isn't going to be in place in time for rural divisions to be out there beating the bushes to hire more algebra teachers so it almost seems unfair that success on this metric depends on hiring more algebra teachers. We're not going to have this

[06:37:40] metric in place until after hiring decisions have been made. So that's one thought. Another thought I think that would help schools accelerate their ability to meet this by year two would be a proposal that I've made to, shared with Dr. Koons already, but I would like to see us, and I know this isn't a board decision, but I think we could encourage the department and the administration to look into making virtual Virginia algebra free to all of our middle schools. And then everybody,

[06:38:16] they're still going to have to hire a local teacher to be in the classroom and grade and take attendance, et cetera. But basically, the issue of availability and accessibility of Algebra one in eighth grade, we can solve that with a solution that we have in hand. We have virtual Virginia algebra. We just charge divisions for it, and it's not cheap. And so why don't we solve that problem before we start holding schools' feet to the fire on this criteria? So my suggestion

[06:38:52] would be, is it a possibility to make this a reporting requirement for year one and not kick begin to be an accountability requirement until we've tested it and done more to make school, given schools more opportunity to rise to the occasion. Dr. Koontz? So I just want to give some clarifications on

Virtual Virginia. We do have a lot of school divisions, rural and otherwise, who have staffing shortages. For example, I was talking to a school division earlier this week that is using Virtual Virginia to do all of their physics courses. They are not hiring a second

[06:39:29] teacher virtual virginia scores their own work you do not have to hire a teacher to score they are also using a funding model that is in legislation around how we fund virtual virginia and it is based on an lci component but when we modeled out the funding with innovative models to staff the in-person section that is less than it costs for full-time teacher so we are working with brian mott who is the executive director of virtual virginia and have a meeting next week to promote options for school divisions across the commonwealth we also met with the leadership council of superintendents and talked about what they would like to see in virtual virginia

[06:40:12] am i right that even if they don't have to have a teacher locally they're going to have to have for shall i say crowd control purposes there's going to have to be an adult in the room locally if it i mean my my own daughter did virtual virginia in 50 000 years ago took out uh chinese in middle school and she had a virtual virginia electronic teacher she had a virtual virginia in-person teacher who called her and consulted with her and graded her but she also

[06:40:45] had a physical there was a teacher in the room at her middle school supervising her and and her fellow students behavior and attendance etc i don't think it's a licensed personnel it might It might have been in that case, but it wouldn't necessarily need to be, but it's still a warm body.

[06:41:06] It's a responsible adult. Sure. Why don't I have Brian Mott or someone from Virtual Virginia and my team come and present on all the options and the funding options and options to the board in July? Would that be helpful? At some point, certainly.

[06:41:21] But my proposal would be that until we address this, and at least until we give school divisions a year, I mean, right now, they've got many school divisions start school in six weeks or less, especially in our rural communities.

[06:41:38] And we haven't adopted these rules yet, and we're not going to adopt them until at least July. So do we really want to hold schools accountable in year one to these criteria when they've had no opportunity to respond to these challenges by hiring accordingly?

[06:41:59] Dr. Northern. So, I guess I'm just trying to think this through. Right now, readiness is chronic absenteeism, advanced coursework, and eighth grade pathways, performance tasks. So, we don't have the performance task yet, and we'd say we'd only be reporting on advanced coursework, and then chronic absenteeism is nobody's favorite indicator. So, I guess, you know, then we'd be saying it'd be all on chronic absenteeism, I think. Well, you know what I do would be to move the points over to growth mr rotherham i'm a little confused about this

[06:42:38] conversation because the data we're looking at here this is student data not availability in these communities data correct you're saying that you're saying that it's 96 of schools had at least one student passing but the data we're looking at here is just the pass rates across various communities which is concerning some of it for sure the the gaps but it's not percentage of schools that are offering this that's what i mean right i'm a little confused by the conversation yeah 96 of schools have at least one student who passed passed not took but passed uh middle school

[06:43:16] eoc math the gap would be students who are performing highly in math but aren't necessarily taking that class so actually that's not a gap at all that's it's a different number of like how they get up to that level or how they boost their uh scores would be finding more of those students and making sure that they take and are successful in those math courses so the pathways exist in most of the commonwealth i'm struggling i don't doubt we have a shortage problem some communities the data on that's clear i don't doubt that there's gaps and that's a problem and so forth but i'm having trouble getting the right where this is an acute shortage problem based on this data that's

[06:43:54] i'm having trouble you would have if you talk principals superintendents would tell you there is a significant issue staffing advanced math classes in middle schools in many parts of the state it may not be reflected fully there those 96 some of those may be using virtual virginia which costs the local division some of it may be uh that they are can afford one algebra class but not two when they need it uh etc etc so the the if for instance the 47 in rural areas doesn't mean

[06:44:27] that 53 took the class and failed that means some percentage didn't take the class and some percentage took the class and failed so the denominator is the number who were eligible for the class as as chad has defined it and then the numerator is how many of those took it and passed. Right. I don't doubt any of that's a problem. I'm just struggling with, from this data, how we can necessarily be diagnosing beyond anecdotally. Yeah, there are two points that aren't in this slide. One is that the pass rates for these students is very high. I mean, I said

[06:45:06] this at the last meeting I can't remember the exact, it's 97, 98% of kids who are taking an EOC math course in eighth grade are passing. So that to me suggests that schools potentially aren't giving the pathway to as many students that would be successful in those. And so I think the way this would work in an accountability system, it would only count for a school that had a sufficient number of students who met the denominator. That means that they had enough students who were passing or successful in seventh grade math that deserved an opportunity to be successful in

[06:45:41] advanced math in eighth grade and whether they actually, whether the school actually met those student's needs or not. And then on the other indicators, I think Ms. Holton's point, the denominators is a good one, but are there other workarounds? Like what else? Because like broadening, I mean, math is obviously super important and there's some predictive power attached to it, but these other things matter too. Are there any workarounds on that?

[06:46:08] I'm struggling with a great answer for that one. I would say, yeah, we've looked at, go ahead. I think the way that we were thinking about this, if we added the science and the history, and social studies in. If it's not three separate calculations, it's one calculation.

[06:46:35] So you might consider the eligible students in the denominator to look at not just were you successful in seventh grade math, but also were you successful in seventh grade reading? So that might be your denominator, but your numerator would just be if a student passed any of these EOC. So it would likely raise the rate slightly from just math, sort of like how when we were talking about the mastery index, going with the equal approach would have raised that number a little bit. This would also probably raise that number a little bit because you're

[06:47:11] going to be catching, you know, students who were successful in science and history as well as students who are successful in math. And I'll just, again, I'm not trying to overstate the teacher shortage thing because we know what the teacher shortage is but there's the again in urban areas you can often

move staff between middle schools and high schools they teach part day or part day there it's a little more cute in rural areas the other thing is that unlike math where you can get the a middle school teacher with a middle school license can get an algebra one add-on they can get the endorsement to get to add on the algebra one endorsement

[06:47:50] that doesn't exist for the other science areas so a middle school teacher can't just add on they have to actually go get the endorsement for earth science or have to get the endorsement for you know high school history or so that there's there's also licensure pieces there that i just would caution again i like that idea i think there's there's some some potential there um but as that might lead to more modeling which we've already done a lot of modeling i think that we're going to try lightly into this it looks like math is the lower hanging fruit maybe with fewer snares

[06:48:26] Any other comments or anything before we move on? We're going to go to high school now and Anne's going to take over for that. So we have two things to discuss within the high school component, but these are the final two things. So this can power through a little bit longer. As a reminder, we are looking in this section both really at the readiness component again, which in high

[06:49:04] schools is 35%. So it's the highest of any grade span. And it includes chronic absenteeism, the college career military and civic readiness or ready for life as we've been calling it it also looks at an alternate graduation measure which we're going to talk a little bit more now first so right now we use the graduation and completion index in the accreditation system and that includes students who earn all of these different types of diplomas and certificates it looks at the students who get the advanced studies diploma and the standard diploma but also considers the

[06:49:44] applied studies diploma students who earn GEDs certificates of completion or individual student alternative education plans in particular the applied studies diploma is only available again to students who are have a disability and have an IEP it's not able to be included in that federal graduation rate indicator because it's not aligned to the state standards. So that's why in that graduation component, we're just using the FGI. But we do have the ability in this readiness component to consider an alternate metric like the GCI. So these are all the different types of

[06:50:22] diplomas that are recognized in the GCI. In addition, it does consider sort of students who need additional time so those students are called sliders so you can see 70 points are given in the gci to a student who might be an english learner or a student with disability who is able to have more than four years to graduate um so they're given sort of 70 points for remaining in school um the ged is given 75 points a certificate of completion is 25 points and then 100 points for

[06:50:57] any type of diploma applied studies standard diploma or advanced diploma and that also includes students who maybe weren't in that cohort so it's different from the federal rate in that sense too that this includes what's called carryover students so a student who maybe graduated with a standard diploma in five years would be counted in that year so that is sort of the mechanics of the current GCI and for reference this is the in the model one data we used the GCI so we did sort

[06:51:29] of run some of the model data with this indicator however there are other options for what we could do so we thought it'd be helpful to come back with some data we talked about this in April I wanted to give you a sense sort of of how many students are earning these different diploma types and these different pathways. So the vast, vast majority of students in Virginia are earning an advanced studies or an

IB diploma or the standard diploma. Virginia has a very high graduation rate, something that we often tout as a good statistic. So that's 88.8%. So nearly 90% of kids are getting

[06:52:07] one of those two diploma types and are counted in the federal graduation rate indicator. There is, you know, for 6.5% of the cohort, they are earning one of these other diplomas. So we have about 1,800 students who are getting an applied studies diploma. That is the most common of the alternate pathways, but you see there's sort of lower numbers of students who are getting a GED or certificate of completion or that individual student alternative certificate. And then there are, you know, those students in roughly 3,500 that are still enrolled. So that's kind of the

[06:52:43] breakdown here so you can just see the numbers. What that looks like when we see the data here is that the gray bars here on both the right and left side are the kids that are counted in that federal four-year rate. So that's the 88% of kids or nine that are getting that standard diploma or the advanced studies diploma in four years. If you just consider the difference between the two sides is that on the right side, we have the graduation and completion index, which again considers all of those different types of certificates like GEDs, and also considers students staying in school.

[06:53:22] If you add that on, you get to about 91.5% of kids are sort of recognized. Alternatively, on the left side, this is an extended year graduation rate. So this is still considering that cohort but just looking at students who graduate in five or six years but only earning a standard diploma or an advanced studies diploma this is not looking at it the applied studies diploma and you'd see statewide you get to a very similar outcome of about close to 92 percent of kids so i just want to say that like at the aggregate level the two choices presented here

[06:54:01] are kind of similar so this is i think we're weighing sort of the directions for the model i mentioned in model one we used the sort of current option we considered the graduation and completion index i think we weighted it at five percent of the 35 percent in the high school model um we're recognizing all those different types of diploma options ged certificates of completion students who stay in school in model two we actually included a different graduation

[06:54:34] metric. So for Model 2, we looked at an extended cohort rate. So those students who maybe graduated with a standard diploma or an advanced studies diploma in five years, but we also included students who earned an advanced studies diploma. We excluded students who had a GED or another certificate of completion, but we were looking at the advanced studies diploma. So that it's still kind of that cohort measure. It's not necessarily bringing in kids who are in a different class, but graduated, but was just saying, you know, let's, we know some kids might need more time, particularly students' disabilities need more time. So let's include that option. So that's

[06:55:13] what we included in model two. So I think, you know, all of this is, and I think they were both weighted at 5%. So we didn't change the weighting, we just changed the measure. And, you know, like I sort of said, I think this doesn't have a huge impact, the high level in terms of what the overall rate for the state is. It's really, I think, a signal about, you know, do we want to sort of keep things the same, recognize all these different diploma pathways, or would you really want to lean in on the Applied Studies Diploma, the Standard Diploma, and the Advanced Studies

[06:55:46] Diploma? Any questions on this? And again, this is really to give us some direction for which graduation metric we put into Model 3. So, Anne, help me understand, both of these options would be

okay, it would meet the federal requirements. Yes, because we're including as a separate measure that 15% on the federal graduation rate indicator, this is just additive on top of that. So as long

[06:56:21] as we have that 15%, we can have alternate graduation measures. And if we wanted to ensure that our, that we are trying to push for diplomas versus other things that are included in GCI to raise expectations. We would want to be over here on the extended rate option side, correct? Is that what you're saying? I think so. I mean, I think that is the main difference. In some ways, it's also a little simpler. It doesn't have points and like 25 points for this, 70 points for it. It's

[06:56:57] just the numerator is any student who graduated and we could use a five-year rate or a six-year rate who got one of those three diploma types. Okay. Mr. Hanson, go ahead. I just have a question more. I think either approach, it's going to be similar. So this is kind of a minuscule data point, but what are we seeing in the state right now in terms of the last three years of chronic absenteeism and the learning loss and the potential need for some of these alternative

[06:57:36] graduation opportunities whether it's default or dropout recovery programs or other things are we seeing data that they're just kind of where we are now but is it going to change the dynamics of even what we might want to prioritize or have them accountable for i do think we are seeing more extended rate type needs i think it's hard to determine if learning loss per se or attendance is impacting the other certificate options especially since one of those options are

[06:58:12] students with disabilities um but i can have the team run that kind of information as you're thinking through this especially this year's data is not not collected yet but we could at least run it for two years ago which hopefully has a much higher chronic epiphany than this year i know that you clarified this but i think some of us are tired and this is not part of the graduation component this is part of the readiness component so when some of us are asking about

[06:58:48] what's allowable the graduation measure that you are talking about is a four-year adjusted cohort rate what you are now talking about with gci and the other pieces are part of the readiness correct and that's what makes it okay yeah the fact that it's in that orange box i just i know we're all tired i just want to make sure that clarified that miss holton so can you flip back to the gci whoops it's doing fancy it's magic uh well i i

[06:59:29] Well, that wasn't the one I was looking for, but I can ask my question without it. The proposal, either version, I was looking for the slide with current option or the alternative option.

[06:59:44] Thank you. That one. Thank you. Either way, the current GCI or the extended rate option would include all of the four-year adjusted rate grants. So in other words, the measure would not simply be how many people showed up in this extended category, total graduates, including the broader definition.

[07:00:11] Thank you. I mean, if that's the case, and I said this last meeting, I really like the Louisiana approach where they have the diploma index, where they've represented all the whole spectrum, because, you know, you still have the four-year adjusted cohort rate in there.

[07:00:31] You get extra points if you got a high school plus associate's degree, you get 160 high school plus AP. I mean, like it actually marries all the other pieces that we've been talking about in the college and career ready indicators and what we want to prioritize there. And yeah, you also are counting the GEDs, which I think I've heard is not getting counted in this calculation.

[07:00:53] So I guess what I would like is just a little bit more, I don't know if you can, I don't know what kind of modeling I have in mind, but just maybe some additional thoughts about what you guys think about the Louisiana Diploma Index and whether it's a little bit more elegant.

[07:01:08] Because right now, if we're already like, I had the same question Anne had. So if you're a school that didn't happen to have alternate, a lot of kids who are getting these alternate measures, and it seems like default, then your 35% would be allocated between two categories instead of three. But if that's not the case, and those kids are also being counted, then why not just put them all in one graduation index?

[07:01:34] So, I think, you know, for all high schools, I'm pretty sure, and if I was wrong on the modeling side, I think all high schools had this additional graduation metric. There wasn't any high school that had the four-year rate, but didn't have the GCI or didn't have the extended rate option. So, essentially, how this was working, and I think this is a little bit of a mechanics of ESSA, unfortunately, and us trying to fit with the federal parameters, is that for high schools, graduation metrics are going to count 20%. That's sort of how you could think about it. Instead of

[07:02:13] it's 15% over here, 5%, but cumulatively, it's 20%, right? And for schools, if a high school is basically having the vast majority of their kids or all of them are getting a standard diploma or advanced studies diploma that rate is pretty much the same you know that 20 those two measures are not that much different from one another but for schools that maybe don't have as many kids getting the standard diploma or the advanced studies diploma they have a lot of applied studies kids they have some that maybe are getting other types those two measures their 15 is going to be lower

[07:02:52] because those kids aren't counted in that portion of the graduation rate that's 15 But that 5% will be a little bit of a higher metric. So it's sort of on net boosting their score a little bit. Is that helpful? So if you have two kids getting the alternate graduation measure, you only have two in a school, is your whatever, I'm just going to say 12% because we've got three buckets here.

[07:03:18] I don't know how much we're going to wait. Are you saying you are calling it 5% in the current readiness bucket? We, yeah, because 5% of the 35% went to that. We're not, we're not lowering it. You know, it's not like every high school is getting 20% in our two models we've run so far to some kind of graduation measure.

[07:03:39] It's never reallocated away from graduation. Is there a minimum N size for that alternate graduate? Can it be on two kids or can it be on 500 kids? So there's the minimum N is on the denominator. So it's the number of kids in the high school or in that cohort. miss holton so two things dr northern i think i understand your question the first is i i think i'm right and and can tell me but our current virginia's current gci is the louisiana model it's almost exactly what theirs is i think it's it's i think it's a difference and that louisiana

[07:04:16] is considering not just diplomas but also then combining things into that like ap exams and industry-recognized credentials. Okay, I stand corrected. And a bunch of other things. I stand corrected. But the other piece is what I think I'm hearing Anne say we're proposing using in readiness is a GCI measure analogous to our current GCI measure, which is not just those alternate students. So our current GCI, every high school now has, you know, say they have

[07:04:53] 100 students in the graduating class or in the ninth grade class, and 90 of them graduate with an advanced or a standard diploma, then our adjusted cohort rate, our federal rate would be 90%. But then

they have five more that are still in school or getting an applied studies diploma.

[07:05:14] So their total number is 95. Their measure on this would be 95, not five. So in other words, those 90 are counted both in the adjusted cohort rate that the feds require us to use and in either one of these options. The number would never be five. It would all be 95.

[07:05:36] I think what I'm saying is I don't see the 90 and the five as apples and apples. I would like to get the five. I think they should be distinguished. If one got a GED, but one got a four-year degree with an AP thing on top of it, like we should give them, we should incentivize that. We should give them more credit. And the diploma index gives everybody credit for a degree, but it doesn't treat the five as the same as the 95 because the 95 got an advanced degree or something like that.

[07:06:08] But those 90 essentially get counted twice. They get counted under the high school graduation adjusted cohort, 15%, and they get counted in this. So those 90 are getting a heavier weight because the applied studies diploma grads are only showing up in one of those two places.

[07:06:28] That's something we should think through. Do we want to be double counting them in two different buckets? I don't know. That's a good question. I do think another question. Dr. Siebert, please. I think it might help to remember that we're talking about a piece of a part here. We're talking about a piece of one part of the thing.

[07:06:45] So I think my deal would help. First of all, after the last meeting, Dr. Northern, I did look at the LA plan, and I thought it was clever and thoughtful. But I think maybe for the future, it has some appeal for me. I think right now, in June of 2020, 2024, it's a little too complex.

[07:07:02] But I do think for the future, it might have some potential. If we could go to slide 51 for just a moment. I actually really, really like both of these bar graphs on slide 51. to go back because um these both tell a very important story uh and and they they they tell actual and then they tell two different stories and they also tell you that you know by and large they're both with diplomas but these kids who graduate in five years i mean it's actually you know that that two tenths who graduate in six years man that's that's worth celebrating that's pretty remarkable so i like that story and the same with the story on the right hand side and And to really get to the right-hand side, we're going to go to slide 52 for just a moment.

[07:07:41] If we go to slide 52 for a moment, oh, I'm sorry, it's the one with the numbers of kids. There it is, my bad. So that's 50. Oh, I had it right on my notes. These are pretty small ends, considering the size of the number of children in Virginia.

[07:08:00] Pretty small numbers. And so we heard a couple minutes ago that at the high level, using the left graph or the right graph, it really doesn't matter at the statewide level because the number is kind of the same. So at the high level, it really doesn't matter. So I want to suggest that at the child level, it does matter, because look at that 681 ISAEPs, okay? I've had very small numbers of ISAEP students I've worked with over the years, but those are powerful stories. Children have overcome huge odds, who have had huge opportunities. Now, is it a four-year, is it a traditional diploma? No.

[07:08:36] And so the idea of weighting it differently, counting it differently, absolutely should be counted differently, but it should be celebrated, just like we celebrate it for those kids, just like we bring in certificate of completion kids and we celebrate those kids and we cut cake, because there's a story for those very small number of kids.

[07:08:54] The GED test is not what it was, you know, in the 80s and 90s. So those are things to celebrate. Now, are they the same as a full-time graduation rate? No. So my suggestion would be looking at those two graphs, knowing that the high level doesn't make any difference. And we're talking about a piece of a part of one indicator that instead of this being an or, this could be an end.

[07:09:16] Since we're talking about the state part of readiness, this could be an end where we include the four year graduation rate is what matters. It's already counting twice, basically, in this thing. then we go ahead and give credit for the five- and six-year rate, and we also give a little bit for what is currently the CCRI or whatever it is, the GCI, all these, so I, because if it doesn't matter, if it doesn't really change the story at the high level, but it matters at the child level, let's celebrate it at the local level.

[07:09:51] I think you could include both of those. First of all, I think from a recording perspective, those graphs are powerful. They're great for recording. And I think for the school, for the readiness piece, we're talking about so small kids, such a small percentage, that leaving it in there is a nice nod to what is done for those children and families.

[07:10:14] So could we average the two for that particular? I think it would be a- How are you saying that, Dr. C? Yeah, I think, so averaging them would be weird because one's a cohort measure, so it doesn't make sense. So there's an option in which you give them both a little bit of weight.

[07:10:32] Like it may not be, right now, this whole integrator is 5%. It just complicates it more. So, I mean, I think to your point, Dr. Siebert, you know, about the kid mattering a lot, That, to me, is lending itself more to going with the current option approach here over the extended option, recognizing that the GCI is giving credit to students who graduate in six years and five years.

[07:10:59] They are counted in that. So it's not like you're not getting the extended rate pieces. There you are. You're just also getting the GEDs, the ISAPs, those kids as well.

[07:11:14] So then in the same vein, can we then, is there any further manipulation that could happen to that current option to bake in some of the stuff that, like Dr. Northern was talking about? So we are trying to bake in some of that stuff through the ready for life indicator.

[07:11:34] We looked and I've looked a lot in my other job at Louisiana's indicator that they use. And I will say Louisiana is moving away from it in part because I think they felt like it was actually measuring graduation more than it was readiness.

[07:11:50] And so I think in their new accountability system, they're going to be having sort of more of a graduation focus and a readiness focus. But a lot of the things that we've talked about as far as those pathways are what we're actually going to talk about in the Ready for Life Indicator and sort of this 3E framework around examining employment, enlistment, and enrollment options.

[07:12:12] Yeah, I'll leave it at this, and this is a point I brought up before, unfortunately. Graduation rates have just ballooned, you know, and many people don't trust the graduation rates anymore. And if we look at ACT scores, there's not been a dramatic spike in those like we've seen in graduation rates. There's not been a dramatic spike in ACT scores. There's not been a dramatic spike in NAEP scores for seniors.

[07:12:42] Nowhere else in education, when we look at graduation scores for 17 and 18 year olds, do we see the spike that we've seen in those. So they're not reflected in any other objective measure. So I just feel like graduation rates have lost a lot of credibility. Unfortunately, I think the work that we're doing on the

sport is excellent because we actually are trying to make graduation more meaningful by baking in these other readiness indicators.

[07:13:07] So I would just caution us just to not rely so heavily on a statistic that seems in many ways to be discredited by other objective measures. Well, Ms. Hulton, this is not what I was going to speak to, but I'll just I'll just note a point of disagreement on the notion of high school graduation rates discredited and maybe we can have that conversation another time.

[07:13:33] But on this specific one, I would just say one advantage of GCI is simplicity because the divisions know it, we've been calculating it, and we are changing so many things right now that anything we can do to simplify may be worth doing.

[07:13:53] So I would incline towards the current option rather than the extended rate option for the reasons Dr. Siebert has cited, but also simply simplicity. People in Virginia know what an adjusted cohort graduation rate is and what a GCI is.

[07:14:10] And while we're changing literally everything, maybe this is one thing that it's just not that big a difference that we need to mess with. The one further question I would raise that we do need to resolve at some point is what weight within the readiness. And you've suggested 5%, but we could do anywhere from 5% up to, I mean, that's a 35% total. So it could be 5%, it could be more, it could be less. And that's a decision that we, I think, need to give these guys direction on at some point.

[07:14:47] I can speak a little bit before we transition into sort of how we thought about the weighting. So like we've said before, chronic absenteeism was a consistent weight across all grade spans in the first two models. So that was a 10%. Then we thought to sort of Dr. Northern's point about the importance of graduation rates and readiness.

[07:15:07] when you consider that alternate graduation metric, whether it was GCI or the extended cohort, we included that at 5%, but we have the four-year FGI at 15. So that was 20% cumulative.

[07:15:23] And then for the ready for life measure that focuses on the three E's, we also weighted it 20%. So you can sort of think of this ready for life and graduation, at least in the two models we've done so far is receiving equal weight, recognizing that both are really important.

[07:15:43] But of course, if there's direction there too, we can adjust that for future modeling, but that's sort of how we at least did it for the first two runs. So I will sort of reiterate, and I think know that Chad mentioned this earlier, for the models that we have run and will continue to run, we are using the current CCCRI measure for ready for life, because that is the data we have. So we're using the data that we have available and divisions have done a lot of work on those two models. This is what we're proposing

[07:16:18] would be a model that would be used when the system is operational. So sort of taking the work that we've done on CCCRI across the Commonwealth, but really expanding on that, building on that, really focusing on outcomes and post-secondary readiness experiences that have the most value beyond high school. And we borrowed a lot from what states like Louisiana have done, where they have these indexes that weight different experiences. Those that are most associated with post-secondary outcomes, you know, those get the highest weight. So we were

[07:16:56] thinking and the proposal here sort of have three different tiers of attainment across enrollment, employment, and enlisted. The tier one, what we're calling here is we get the highest weight.

Those are the experiences that are associated with the strongest post-secondary outcomes. Tier three, the lowest weight, which was like a 0.5, for example, those are experiences that are still valuable, but maybe aren't as strongly associated with those post-secondary success and tier two somewhere in the middle um some discussion questions here is sort of thinking about the weighting across these tiers how we acknowledge students that are completing multiple

[07:17:35] pathways but on the next slide we'll sort of walk through at least our initial thinking around what these tiers could look like for each of the three e's oh skipped one so the first e is enrollment and here we are really focusing not on just sort of participation in college readiness experiences but actual outcomes um we talked about this at the april board meeting looking at students who actually score a credit bearing college ready course on exams like the ap the ib cambridge

[07:18:11] the clep exam um and the distinction here between the one point and the 0.75 point in tier two is looking for students who have had multiple experiences so maybe they took two dual credit courses two enrollment courses and passed with a b that's a pretty higher bar not just minimal passing but a b um or earning an associate's degree or having multiple ap ib clep exams when we say college ready we did look at some research around what different institutions of higher education in virginia what their standards are for accepting scores and we're

[07:18:49] proposing here to use what the virginia community colleges use because they have a uniform statewide policy um when we looked at the other other four-year public institutions um the majority of them for example would accept a three for credit but they're not required to and sometimes even if you go into an institution you'll find differences between departments within the same institution about what they accept so we thought you know for both because you know this is covering a vast majority of students and because the vccs policy is statewide that that would be the one

[07:19:25] to go through with sort of the college um the college ready scores tier three um is sort of scoring below that credit bearing college ready level on one assessment so for example a student getting a two on an ap exam instead of a three a four or five or passing a one dual credit course but not getting that b grade you know maybe getting a c grade so it's trying to still reward and recognize students who have gone through these really important experiences but perhaps not

[07:19:59] um achieved a level that is um as strong or is like uh predictive of post-secondary success i will pause here if there are any questions about the enrollment or any feedback or um reactions i just have a technical question how is this going to work because these scores come back like a student can get an ap score but you could conceivably have a three on an ap very early in your high school career yes you're not going to get your ib scores until actually after you've left they come back the fall of the following year so like how is this mechanically how how

[07:20:35] will this how will this work just given um and i'm not familiar enough with with cambridge to know when those at what point those come back but like how is that going to work so i'm going to speak mostly to how other states that do this um you know i think that there are states that they would collect i mean obviously students might be taking these when they're sophomores or they're juniors

[07:20:57] So it is, again, a cohort measure. So looking at by the time students graduate, other students in that graduating cohort, you know, what type of ready-for-life experiences have they had? So it would be important to sort of be gathering that information. So it would count the 10th grader who got, you know, a 5 on their AP assessment.

[07:21:19] There are some states that because of the data reporting issue, they actually lag this measure. So instead of, you know, we were talking about using data from the 23-24 school year to inform school determinations in the fall of 2025, you would use data from two years past.

[07:21:42] And some states also do that with graduation rates because they want to include summer graduates, for example. So there is a possibility to lag the data by a year if some of the data were not available in time to make timely decisions.

[07:21:56] I just like to raise a concern with putting any significant weight on students, not just taking courses, but passing courses that require a fee for the student to take the course, take the exam, as we know the AP, etc. does, and especially putting extra weight on those who take multiple ones.

[07:22:27] I think we heard from our Student Advisory Council two months ago that cost is a significant barrier to many low-income students for taking AP exams, et cetera. I will say that the good news is, Emily reminded me that our General Assembly did allocate a little bit of money this year to help low-income students pay for those exams, but it's not enough money to support low-income students taking multiple exams. And so, I would raise

[07:23:04] concerns about having any indicator be tied to family economics as much as this one is. But in particular, to require multiple AP tests to rate the highest level, I think, is a mistake.

[07:23:26] So if this were an option, though, Anne, so, I mean, if a school division wanted to put particular emphasis on one of these opportunities over another, that could be the choice of a school division, maybe?

[07:23:46] Yes. So I think that this, we're trying to recognize that there is a lot of different ways that divisions are encouraging students to get prepared for college, to enroll in college. Some have really leaned into the AP program. Some have really leaned into dual enrollment with their local community colleges. Some have done IB programs. I think Cambridge, less common in the Commonwealth, but because it was part of the VCCS policy, just like CLEP, we included it. I think that they are far less used to those.

[07:24:18] So I think AP, IB, and then the dual enrollment programs are really the three main ways that divisions have leaned into preparing students for college enrollment. And I would also say too, I think part of the reason why we saw it, particularly with the multiple here, and I know this particularly in the dual enrollment space more than in the AP space, but there is really good research out there about students who have done sort of, not as someone, as a friend of mine calls it, random acts of dual enrollment.

[07:24:48] So I did like one course in dual enrollment. But if you do sort of a stackable sequence of dual enrollment, whether that's six courses, nine courses, 12 credits, that that is associated with even stronger likelihood of enrolling in college and persisting.

[07:25:06] Maybe Dr. Siebert may know better than me, or some others may be able to help educate me, but it's my understanding that, and part of this is from the presentation we got from the students is that many school divisions are not able to foot the full cost of dual enrollment and AP courses, and therefore pass the cost on to students. And anything that's tied to students' ability to pay, to me, it seems unfair to rate schools more poorly because their students are

[07:25:44] not able to afford tests until we're ready to require full funding for those tests from the school divisions, which I'd be totally in support of. Dr. Siebert? But not universally, but just generally in regions

six and seven, there are extraordinarily terrific relationships between divisions and community colleges. And, you know, you have localities like, you know, Whitfield and others, and there's community college access programs in the Roanoke Valley.

[07:26:17] So it's really a local thing, but there's tremendous relationships. So I think dual enrollment is growing and continue to be a source of investment. I think you saw some legislation in the last session trying to move us more toward dual enrollment and trying to raise the expectation there on the community college system as well, because they're going to get the state ADM for the community college students.

[07:26:40] so so i think that there's some expectations being put community college systems for that so i think that those things are good um in terms of like the uh what you called it the uh the dual enrollment random acts of dual enrollment i think the way to get at that and maybe look at the tiers is you know virginia has established what is in the passport program or we got we got the dual enrollment passport or some terminology close to that that we use that dual enrollment classes they're part of the passport are then recognized by our state universities and community and colleges so i think that those could be probably like in the set i think we're going to use those in the

[07:27:16] set then maybe we can even raise the number of points available uh for things that are in that set because i you know for example a very solid student with very good goals with a touch of dyslexia and a touch dysgraphia who is able to get a c in dual enrolled english at the high school level has a much better chance of succeeding at the university level than the child who doesn't so that that c in english into enrollment um for some children is a huge success and and especially because that's part of the passport program for another child it might be that they're getting

[07:27:55] that college math out of the way at the high school level so i think that those passport programs might might warrant more points great um do you need a decision on this here so this is really directionality this is helpful i will i do want to be sure we get to employment and enrollment because there might be feedback that sort of based on once you have the bigger picture here because a student could be getting one point or 0.75 points in that numerator for enrollment but under this uh scheme they could also be getting one point in the numerator for an employment

[07:28:32] outcome um or for an enrollment or enlistment excuse me outcome so i think that similarly to on the sort of college side of things in college enrollment on employment um thinking really here in particular about cte finishers or partial finishers and the types of industry recognized credentials they could earn that's really the distinguishing factor between the one point the 0.75 and the 0.5 uh tiers here is that students who are earning one point are getting um an industry recognized credential that is in a high demand high wage field versus that tier two is

[07:29:12] more mid-demand mid-wage fields it also includes students who have completed quality work-based learning we did hear from the field that it was important to still give some credit for work-based or service-based learning um but sort of the difference there is between tier two and tier three so that going on tier three these are sort of other industry recognized credentials it also it lets you be a CTE partial finisher, not a full CTE finisher, and, you know, or completing work-based learning or service-based learning that doesn't quite meet the quality bar that the state would want to set. This note here at the bottom in the orange box is also that Virginia is part of an

[07:29:50] initiative called Launch Pathways, which is going to help the team at the VDOE think about and look at data to consider, like, which credentials should fall into which tier, you know, looking at labor demand data and workforce data and those types of things to try and help make that decision.

[07:30:08] So it's not just any industry-recognized credential, but really trying to distinguish those that have the most value. Questions, feedback, reactions. Dr. Northern, please. What is a CTE finisher? Oh, it's a very good question. Testing my knowledge. I don't want to misspeak for anybody, but I think it is based on taking a significant number of CTE fourthways in pathway so is it the same thing as a concentrator which is three courses in the same pathway it's basically the perkins ct concentrator if you know that terminology the terminology is completer

[07:30:46] and so i would defer to our cte expert the other end but a completer is to complete the sequence and again so it didn't it's not that i have welding one and auto service one yes and auto body one but i have completed the pathway in welding or an auto service and auto body i've completed the past right it can't be three scattershot right not random acts of cte that's right and what is a i'm sorry and i just had several questions i should have prefaced with that what is a um a variable work based so the terminology is still a work in progress and i

[07:31:25] think the idea here is that um the video team and sort of led by dr armstrong would really work to think about what makes a quality work-based learning experience you know is what fields make it or sectors make it really quality um what sort of parameters would need to see in order for it to be part of that tier two category and if an experience did not meet those parameters that would be variable so i think we were looking for a term that wasn't low quality basically or the opposite of quality but it didn't meet sort of this the rigor the the bar for rigor that was in

[07:32:01] that tier two category and right now in the current cccri i think kind of all work-based learning experiences are treated the same so this is also trying to help with that so for the high demand the one that gets a point um and i understand what high demand means but what if the school system you know all school systems are going to vary as to which cte courses they offer based on what they can afford to offer and all that so i guess is that kind of um just discriminating

[07:32:37] against a student if their school system doesn't you know their text ctc doesn't offer and i'm assuming all of them offer some high demand obviously but you know i'm asking is that gonna i think that this is you know kind of similar to some of the conversations we've had throughout the day around whether it's advanced math or anything it's like this i think is really a nudge to our school divisions to re-examine their CTE program offerings and say we're not offering many of the pathways that are on the high wage high demand list should we think about adding them you

[07:33:14] know what are our community colleges and our workforce centers doing do we have industry partners so i think that's that's the idea here it's a nudge in that direction um i can go on to enlistment so our final category is um enlistment so really recognizing that military readiness component, which is something that this current CCCRI does to some extent, but this is really trying to lean much more into that. So again, sort of have these different tiers. And the top

[07:33:49] tiers, again, we're looking at that CTE completers. But the difference here is that they've not only earned some kind of industry-recognized credential, but they're also getting a career-ready score on what's called the Armed Forces Qualifying Test, which is part of the ASVAB. So, it's taking sort of four of the ASVAB subscores that are most sort of academic-oriented and not technical-oriented, and that score

would be what would sort of distinguish the Tier 1. For Tier 2, it's quite similar, except rather than that career-ready AFQT score, it's the enlistment score. The

[07:34:27] enlistment score right now for most branches in the military is about a 32, which in terms of AFQT, that is the 32nd percentile. So those scores equate with percentiles. So I know, for example, Louisiana that's debating their new ready measure, they've set their AFQT score for sort of the highest here over a 50. I think it might be 58 or six. So I think there would be a big distinction there between the tier one and tier two. Tier three here is sort of most similar to what we have currently in the CCCRI, focused on earning three JROTC credits in high school and then

[07:35:06] meeting that 31, 32 enlistment score. So happy to answer any questions about this or just get feedback on, do we like this direction? And I'm a little confused because if our goal is ready for life and we're talking about enrollment we're talking about employment and enlistment and a student can earn points in all three why do we have cte finishers here because cte finishers will be counted under the employment so why are we adding it in here i really just need a better

[07:35:43] understanding of that so i think that the way that we were envisioning this working mechanically is that a student would be counted in the numerator for whatever way they earn the most points so a student would be if they were a um if they got an associate's degree in high school but then also you know maybe got an industry recognized credential that was on that mid-tier list they would go for the one point not 1.75 points um so they are so you a student is counted

[07:36:19] in the numerator one time for their highest weight whatever they earn across the three and then i think we also though have and this was sort of the questions i think that we wanted to raise at the end is there are some states that reward students for being ready in multiple ways so we could add that on um part of the challenge that we're trying to think about here it sort of of goes to the mechanics of other indicators is keeping it similar i do think that we need to do some work on this one um because i think that we need to be able to understand why these things are

[07:36:58] being counted two places i'm not sure that i think perhaps they're miscategorized here and i think there might be some pieces missing so why don't we hold on this one okay um and and do some polishing And I think that's totally fine. It's not going to hold up on modeling because we are going to continue using the CCCRI for modeling because this is data that, yeah, that's what we have.

[07:37:25] Okay. Ms. Hulton. So I hear you, it's not going to hold up our modeling, but we need answers. I mean, we need to make decisions on this no later than July, really, right? so um i'm asking for this slide to be right and i'm totally i'm totally comfortable on that but i just want to make sure we understand that we need a a resolution of how is the military readiness indicator going to work put before us in time for a vote in july yeah can we come back on

[07:38:01] this um dr northern yeah and i'll just add um just in terms of apprenticeships um as you're thinking that through it wasn't clear to me you know where they were being captured i think some apprenticeships actually don't lead to an industry recognized credential but it doesn't mean that we shouldn't count apprenticeships in some fashion thanks thank you dr northern dr sievert yes thank you dr northern that was that was on my list um a lot of apprenticeships where the children are getting paid and getting the on for a place that they're getting the skills they're also on time for work and doing a lot of other good things that probably is a tier one thing it's different

[07:38:39] than a workplace experience so i would probably look at that i like the whole three e's um i do think this is the area which obviously is still developing and so it needs more work i think part of that work um is going to be feedback i think you know the idea of connecting it to the passport program for dual enrollment i think you know there is there are random acts of dual enrollment and of CTE, but also of AP. I don't know that we should lump all AP courses the same way as well.

[07:39:06] So, again, there's people more current in this area than me that should probably think about. And then I would also encourage, again, to talk about the apprenticeship piece, but I think this is an area where the field could probably be very helpful, especially the CTE directors in the Commonwealth are very, very strong, and a lot of them are 12-month employees and could probably lean in and help on this.

[07:39:33] Thank you. Yeah, so we can definitely come back in July with more discussion on this. I think, you know, we, and I don't, did the handout go to the board? Okay, so there are some states we really leaned into, I think kind of based on some of the feedback from the last board meeting into a model that was more similar to Louisiana's, which they really are focusing on just the rigor of the experience.

[07:39:57] But they don't give students any sort of extra credit or extra weight for doing a rigorous enlistment experience and a rigorous enrollment experience. They just are focusing on whatever your most rigorous thing is, that's what you get. So I think when we come back in July, we can also think about this idea of maybe rewarding students who demonstrate readiness in multiple areas, as well as just sort of the rigor.

[07:40:21] That could be something we bring in. We also, I think, had here on the last slide to a civics component as well that I just wanted to be sure that we mentioned since we could also more fully discuss that in July as well but just about rewarding similarly like a bonus point to students who do who pass the U.S. citizenship test so happy to bring all of this back for no I don't know that everything needs to be brought back that military one particular slide needs work the military one yes the military I think we have a fundamental conversation around the 3E framework because we have gone out in the field

[07:40:59] in two sets of listening sessions and said a student counts an and. You said the student counts one time. I think we need to bring that conversation back. A student, we have talked repeatedly about making sure a student can count multiple times and we have places who are really incentivizing students to get an associate's degree and be a CTE completer and get an endorsement. We need to be able to recognize those multiple pathways and options, and that was one of the key parts of the 3E framework. It doesn't sound to me like that's represented, so we need to have a conversation.

[07:41:33] That was clear feedback we got in every single region, so we probably need to come back and put that in front of the board in some way, shape, or form in the way that we receive that feedback. Yeah, just, and also there was some concern about, like, what exactly is service-based learning and work-based learning, and maybe we can get some examples of that in July as well.

[07:42:02] I just, my biggest concern is just, obviously, that there'd be some control, some attention to quality to those experiences. Can we go to the slide about the civics test?

[07:42:19] Sure. So, help me understand, this is not, I mean, I think this is an intriguing idea, and I understand some states have adopted some version of using the U.S. citizenship test. Virginia has not done that in the past. We have not aligned our history and government standards to the U.S.

[07:42:45] citizenship test. I looked at the 100 questions on the citizenship test yesterday when I saw this, and frankly, there are a number of questions on there that are not aligned with our current government standards and maybe should be, but aren't yet. So I think this is definitely something worth thinking about, but I wonder how we're going to do that in time for implementation in the current upcoming school year. Who's going to teach these courses? Who's going to administer the test?

[07:43:21] How's it going to be administered? Is it, are there going to be any accommodations for students with disabilities? Are there going to be any accommodations for English language learners? um uh is it are we going to administer the whole hundred question test in writing or are we going to do it a sample of 10 orally as is done for the u.s citizenship test for for actual citizen

[07:43:53] applicants so where are we on developing any of this have we vetted it at all with the field this and and i will that's my question set of many many questions i would think would take properly a lot of detailed time for us to dig into and and i will go ahead and add my comment is it seems like something worth thinking about completely inappropriate to think about it as part of this accountability rewrite especially with the implications it has for our schools to

[07:44:29] actually teach new content, not otherwise in the SOLs, when we are asking them to do so much new stuff already in the 24, 25 school year. I know that's a question and a comment, but I merged it all together for efficiency. If I could just address that, between U.S. government and civics, all of those test questions on the test have been taught in some way, shape, or form.

[07:45:00] Well, they're not all in the standards. And are you talking about the standards we're teaching right now or the newest? The new ones. For instance, one of the questions, one of my favorite questions. Let me ask you a question. Did you review the U.S. government SOLs and the civics SOLs?

[07:45:19] Well, we reviewed them all when we went through. I reviewed them all when we adopted them. But one of my favorite examples is one of the questions is, Who is your current, who are your two current United States senators and who is your current United States representative?

[07:45:36] I'm sure many teachers teach it in civics. Many teachers teach it. It is not in the SOLs, new or old. Ms. Colton, our team, you asked who has done the work. So I want to clarify that our team has done the analysis and our team has confirmed that this content is covered.

[07:45:57] Our subject matter experts have done that analysis. Can you answer on the who's going to administer this test and when and accommodations? Have we thought all that through? I do think it's important for the word bonus to be brought to the attention of everyone here.

[07:46:13] This is a bonus opportunity. This isn't a requirement. I just think if anybody has taught, I am so proud, and I know Dr. Kuhn absolutely shares this because she's regularly expressing it of how hard our schools are working to get ready for the Virginia Literacy Act implementation this fall. They are also working really hard to get ready for new math standards. We're going to determine sometime during the upcoming school year

[07:46:47] entirely new cuts new tests and new cut scores for math and English language arts throughout all the grade bands if we tell our schools now that we're gonna have them administer a new test on top of everything else that nobody's vetted with them in any way that i've heard for which some schools are going to get a bonus just administering it and figuring out accommodations and figuring out the el aspect of it this is disrespectful to the school divisions and

[07:47:21] everything else we have already asked them to do, which is already overwhelming them. I just fundamentally disagree. I think this, I probably for 30 years taught a Boy Scout citizenship in the nation merit badge for two hours, where most of this type of stuff, like the topic you just mentioned, is addressed. And again, most of this, if not all of it, is already addressed, either in state standards or the NAEP, federal. I think we can figure out

[07:47:54] way to make this work and i think we're making much to do about nothing mr rotherham yeah this seems doable with the bonus thing my one question is as i understand in this paper you take 10 questions you need to get six of them right so the one question i think is are we just going to crosswalk to that um or are we doing something else it seems like we would probably crosswalk to that any of the states that have adopted this whoa sorry can you please let mr rotherham start that would be my only question i'd want clarification simply crosswalking to uh what

[07:48:28] new citizens are expected to do if i may many of the states i'm sorry many of the states that have adopted this are not just doing a six ten random questions but rather administering all hundred questions and then scoring 60 out of the hundred the the naturalization test is an oral test six random samples but somebody's got to make all those decisions and then somebody's got to administer the test those 100 questions or the 10 questions either way and they've got to grade it

[07:49:02] accurately by what's what congressional division you're in etc etc so it's not that it's huge it's not that it's not worthy it's just not appropriate to add it on here at the last minute with no input from the field when we've asked them to do so much else already at this time any other comments or questions here yeah just i mean i think this is mr rotherham i think this is doable and it seems peculiar for us to somehow argue that in 12 years we're not going to do what we expect new citizens to do to become part of this community i'm there's been a couple of arguments

[07:49:41] that i've had trouble following and i'll add this one to this one to the to the list um like this assuming we don't do it in some incredibly cumbersome way that seems like both attainable aspirational and actually from a civics perspective uh really important i don't want to editorialize but i feel like a lot of a lot of people might benefit from a tour through the citizenship test and that battery of questions um uh so i think this is i think this is actually exciting as a bonus criteria and a signal that this that this matters and because it does it it otherwise seems

[07:50:13] a lot of work dr siebert part of the i think this conversation is anchored into the fact that we are doing a whole lot of accountability work knowing that on the horizon we need to do a whole lot of assessment work and i look forward to that opportunity but it is absolutely necessary that virginia modernize its assessments that's the only way we can honor the accountability system that that is being built and and so that is a big undertaking unto itself and without a doubt

[07:50:47] civics in u.s virginia history uh need to be a conversation in that i do i'm interested in learning more on how other states use this particular assessment dr northern yeah i'm hearing you know um miss holton's points and i guess for me it all comes down to the bonus like if it wasn't a bonus you know i think i'd feel differently um it's an opt-in it's not a

[07:51:25] required um you know requirement i have a feeling that many districts will actually welcome the opportunity to have a bonus you know especially if they're you know they're nervous about something else um so to me i see it more as like it's um it's an it's an advantage and not a disadvantage in terms of a

bonus i will say however that yes i absolutely think that you know we need to provide them guidance in terms of some of the questions that miss holton is raising i think

[07:51:59] that's it all right well we only have really one more slide left so we are at the end and that is just the what comes next slide if i can get there all right so thank you all for i know this was a long presentation so really appreciate all the thoughtful questions comments feedback it's going to be very helpful to us um and the rest of the team as we move forward um we do have the vote tomorrow on those performance categories it seems like days ago but it was just a few hours ago that

[07:52:35] we talked about those so that is coming tomorrow but then in july we are going to do some continued system modeling and student group modeling taking the feedback we heard today bringing coming back sort of with model three um the public comment period for the regulations also ends in early july so we will bring back information what we got from the public on their draft regulations we're also going to be starting to talk about the ESSA state plan so that is more of the details the meat on the bones about how the system would work and what we would be submitting to the to the U.S.

[07:53:10] Department of Education um when the ESSA plan has been reviewed it then also goes out for a public comment period so that's going to be happening later in this summer so another chance again back to our sort of core principles about stakeholder engagement stakeholders will have a chance to weigh in on that plan as well, with the goal that we will sort of be able to have a final vote on that draft as a plan at the end of the summer and the regulations finalized in September. So that is sort of the roadmap ahead. So you will be seeing us again in July. Ms. Hulton? So I'm counting up

[07:53:49] at least a dozen or so decision points that have been mentioned today as needing direction, but that we have not yet given you direction on, perhaps the most important being the cutoffs between the categories.

[07:54:10] So do we want a bell curve? What shape do we want? Do we want the bell curve leaning one way or another would be a really important question we haven't given you any feedback on. We haven't had any discussion at all about the item we're going to vote on tomorrow, which is the labels for the performance categories.

[07:54:28] the on-track, off-track, et cetera, language. I don't yet understand much about what the levels, how those categories are going to tie to levels of support. And so I hope we hear more on that before we make any final decisions about those categories.

[07:54:49] Those are just among a few, but some of the weighting questions, how much are we going to weight English language learners? How much are we going to wait? Whatever the alternate graduation measure is, et cetera, et cetera. So when are you all thinking we're going to give you more guidance on that, those various decision points that we haven't yet given you guidance on? And some of them you haven't yet given us options on.

[07:55:15] So I think for the weighting question, that's certainly something that's going to be in the ESSA plan. So I think based on what we've heard today about things that you all liked in Model 2 and Model 1, you know, we preferred this, I think we will be able to run at least another model for maybe even two. We'll see. Time is fast, but we will at least be able to do one more model.

[07:55:38] And then I think that would give us, based on that, if the model results look well, that would be a place where in the ESSA plan, we could say it makes sense for English language proficiency to be 10%.

That was one thing we heard, you know, let's split the baby between 5% and 15%.

[07:55:54] Let's go with 10%. So that perhaps would be the weight for that indicator we put in the ESSA plan. So I think the modeling and the ESSA plan kind of go hand in hand for July. So I think we have good direction there. And some of the things that we have talked about are decisions that are important to make, but they are not required to be addressed in the ESSA plan. So I also want to be clear that we're going to, some of the things on that, the U.S. Department of Education doesn't need to know.

[07:56:30] But even if the department, even if they're not required for the S plan, our divisions need to know them before the school year starts. So don't we need to make decisions? We need to have an accountability framework that we know how it's going to work. So our divisions will know how it's going to work.

[07:56:48] And we don't want that in, you know, after the school year starts, do we? Yeah, we will present, as we talked about on your pre-call, we'll present that one-pager framework and that accountability framework with the directions that were provided today for first review in July.

[07:57:06] Yeah, so all of those. And Dr. Coons, you've got enough direction from, and as I say, I'm counting many, many questions we haven't yet weighed in on, but you think you've got enough direction from us to come forward with a proposal for our consideration in July. I'll just say my closing statements right now.

[07:57:23] I am so thankful for the board to spend four or four and a half hours really digging in on next steps on a deck. And thank you to Chad and Ann for spending such extensive time working with models, with decision points, and helping us guide through the critical decisions for our accountability framework.

[07:57:41] We are more than happy to bring that framework for vote and for conversation, both in the work session and the final decision point in July. But I just want to thank everyone because this has been a labor of love and a labor of conversation. We have had many, many conversations. Katie Carroll has had many virtual conversations over the past months to get feedback and guidance.

[07:58:02] So I'm really thankful for each and every one of you and your feedback and conversation today. Thank you. Amazing remarks now. I would just remind everyone that tomorrow is our business meeting.

[07:58:21] So as we have for the last few meetings, we've done a really good job of making sure that we're moving through business without using the time on Wednesday where we've discussed items to move the business forward in our business meeting on Thursday. So I hope you got your questions answered today that needed to be answered in order to accomplish our business on the agenda for tomorrow in an efficient and effective way. So I appreciate you all.

[07:58:57] Thanks to all the help to rearrange our room today so that we could have a little bit more space. And I think with that, unless anybody else has remarks, we will adjourn for the day. Thank you.

Coraggio Consulting · aguyonx.com